Global Equity Volatility Insights

The age of idiosyncratic risk

Defensive bubbles blew in Dotcom era too

Concerns around the AI boom continue to weigh on US tech, with the Nasdaq selling off nearly 3% last week on 22-Oct. As the AI trade wobbles, defensives like healthcare and staples have seen a historic rotation that has paradoxically pushed their BRIs towards bubble-risk levels. It turns out this is not unprecedented as we saw similar behaviour in the late 90s Dotcom era and COVID melt-ups. These dynamics provide further evidence that markets continue to move towards a more bubble-like state, a view we put forward in our 2026 Year Ahead report. Additionally, yields falling concurrently with last week's equity selloff further validates our view that prolonged AI-driven weakness is likely to trade as a growth shock, and we continue to favour NDX max lookback puts contingent on lower rates as a longer-term AI hedge despite the recent moves in rates and in the correlation entry point. Looking ahead, the passage of a slew of key catalysts over the next few weeks could serve as a clearing event for risk and catalyse a bullish shift in sentiment. In this scenario, call spreads on SMH, TMUS and others provide attractive, defined-risk ways to keep up with a potential rally.

The age of idiosyncratic risk

Single-stock fragility remains a defining feature in equities, with elevated stock volatility and outsized moves continuing through 2026. Earnings remain a key driver of this fragility, but the pricing of event risk is increasingly diverging across regions. US earnings volatility risk measures have risen, yet realised moves have outpaced these, particularly among megacaps. In Europe, implied earnings risk is close to historical extremes but has failed to realise so far. The result is a divergence in the attractiveness of earnings optionality, with US stock options continuing to offer value over reporting season, while European earnings vol looks rich.

Also in the GEVI

Global x-asset stress at highs since April as stress rises across asset classes & regions
BRI: Defensives bubble as AI & tech wobble

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27 October 2026

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Exhibit 1: 3M volatility (1-week chg)
Level & changes (in parentheses) in vol pts

	Implied	Realized
S&P500	15.9 (0.9)	11.1 (0.0)
ESTX50	17.4 (1.8)	12.1 (0.4)
FTSE	13.8 (1.4)	9.0 (-0.4)
DAX	17.4 (1.7)	11.7 (-0.2)
NKY	28.7 (1.9)	26.7 (-2.0)
HSCEI	20.3 (1.4)	16.0 (1.3)
KOSPI	43.2 (3.6)	66.7 (-2.6)
EEM US	24.3 (1.2)	22.2 (-0.3)
XIN9I	17.6 (-0.1)	13.1 (-0.3)

Source: BofA Global Research

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See list of acronyms at the end of the report

BofA GFSI™ X-Asset Risk Landscape

GFSI back to highs since April as cross-asset stress rises

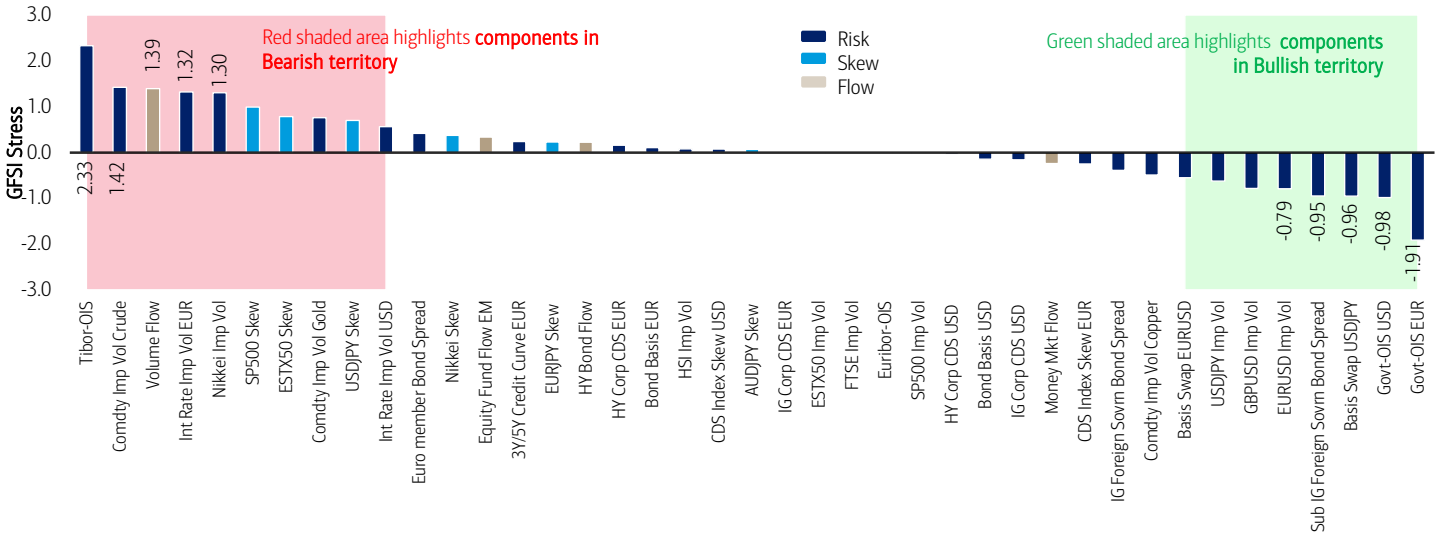
The GFSI increased from +0.09 on 16-Oct-26 to +0.20 on 23-Oct-26 as stress increased across asset classes and regions (Exhibit 4 & Exhibit 5). This lifted the index to its 66th percentile since 2000 and its highest level since 7-Apr, when the GFSI reached +0.33 amid heightened oil and global equity vol stress.

As in April, commodities and equities are the most stressed asset classes, and both led the rise in stress last week (Exhibit 4). Six of the seven largest stress increases came from commodity or equity subcomponents, led by crude implied vol as oil vol rose alongside futures prices (Exhibit 3). Crude implied vol stress rose to its highest level since 31-Jul, when the conflict in Iran was more active, with its weekly increase ranking in its 93rd percentile since 2000. HSI implied vol stress also posted a top-decile increase, while European and Japanese equity skew components were also among the largest stress gainers (Exhibit 3 & Exhibit 6).

Stress increases across the other asset classes were smaller, with credit, FX and rates all remaining below their long-run medians (Exhibit 4). Interest rate implied vol EUR was the only subcomponent outside equities and commodities among the top seven stress-gainers as it moved up to the fourth most stressed subcomponent (Exhibit 2 & Exhibit 3). Meanwhile, Euro member bond spreads and USDJPY skew led the increases in credit and FX stress, respectively (Exhibit 3).

- **Equity vol posted the largest increase in stress versus all cross-asset vols and spreads** (Exhibit 7), but rates and commodity vols are still more stressed than equity vol.
- **European stress is now above long run median levels** (Exhibit 5). ESTX50 skew recorded the largest stress gain among European subcomponents (Exhibit 3).

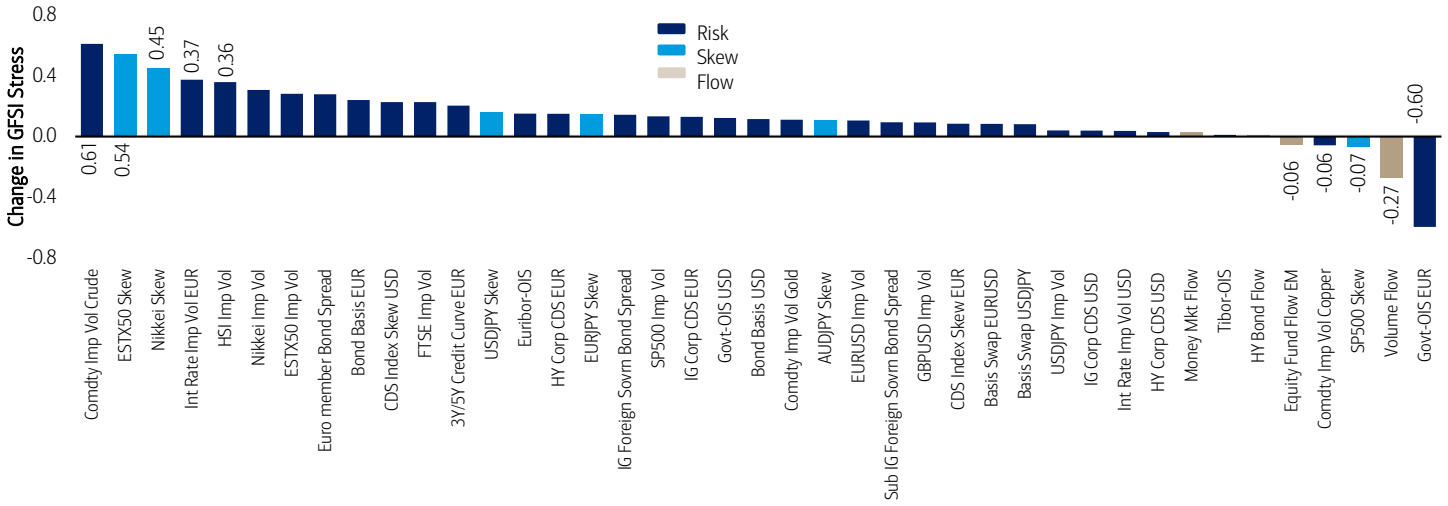
Exhibit 2: Latest* stress across GFSI sub-components
Tibor-OIS is the most stressed while Govt-OIS EUR is the least stressed



Source: BofA Global Research. *Latest as of 23-Oct-26. Disclaimer: The indicator identified above as BofA GFSI is intended to be an indicative metric only and may not be used for reference purposes or as a measure of performance for any financial instrument or contract, or otherwise relied upon by third parties for any other purpose, without the prior written consent of BofA Global Research. This indicator was not created to act as a benchmark.

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Exhibit 3: Change in stress across GFSI sub-components**
Crude implied vol was the largest stress riser over the last week while Govt-OIS EUR stress fell the most

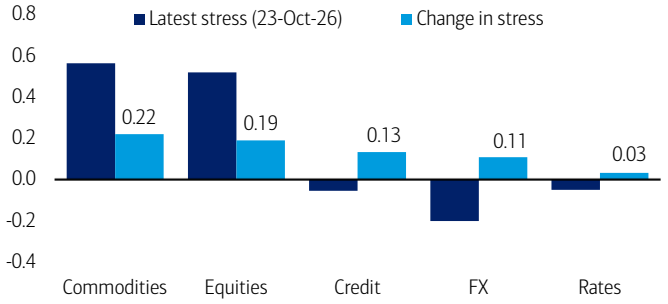


Source: BofA Global Research. **Latest as of 23-Oct-26. Change from 16-Oct-26 to 23-Oct-26.

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The GFSI Risk Allocator (using Bull, Bear & Neutral weights of 2, 0, 1) suggested a 4.9% underweight position as of 23-Oct-26 (vs a neutral position as of 16-Oct-26). The percentages of Bullish, Bearish, and Neutral GFSI components (as used in the Risk Allocator) as of 23-Oct-26 were 19.5%, 24.4%, and 56.1%, respectively.

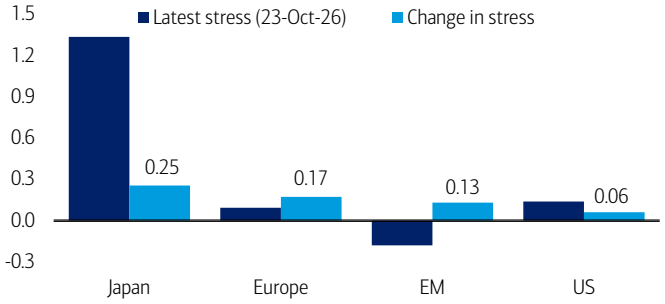
Exhibit 4: Commodity stress increased the most last week
On the other hand, rates stress increased the least



Source: BofA Global Research. Change from 16-Oct-26 to 23-Oct-26.

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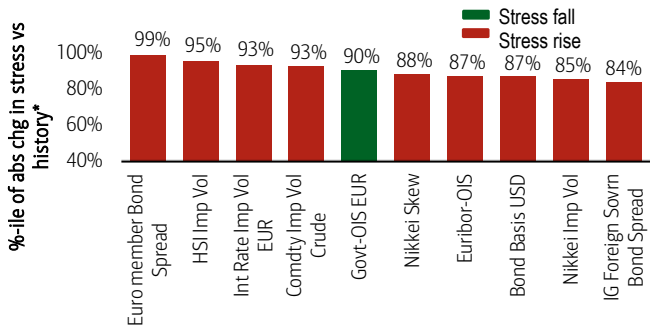
Exhibit 5: Japan led regional stress higher last week
In contrast, the US recorded the smallest increase



Source: BofA Global Research. Change from 16-Oct-26 to 23-Oct-26.

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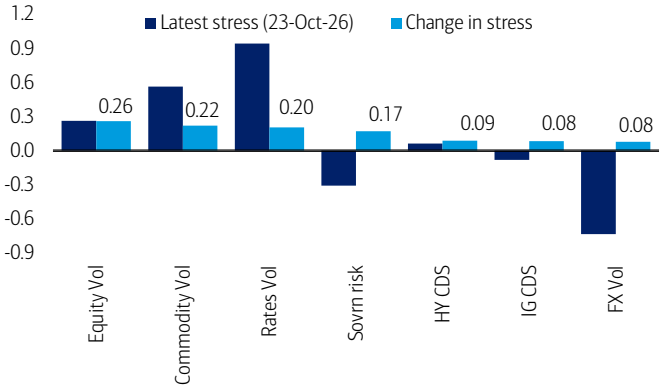
Exhibit 6: Top 10 biggest stress movers (vs history)
Euro member bond spreads saw a historically large stress increase



Source: BofA Global Research. * %-ile of 5-day moves in stress vs all historical 5-day moves (earliest 3-Jan-00). Bar colors represent rise (red) or fall (green) in stress. 5-day change (16-Oct-26 to 23-Oct-26).

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Exhibit 7: Biggest stress movers in cross-asset vols and spreads
Equity vol experienced the largest increase in stress last week



Source: BofA Global Research. Change from 16-Oct-26 to 23-Oct-26.

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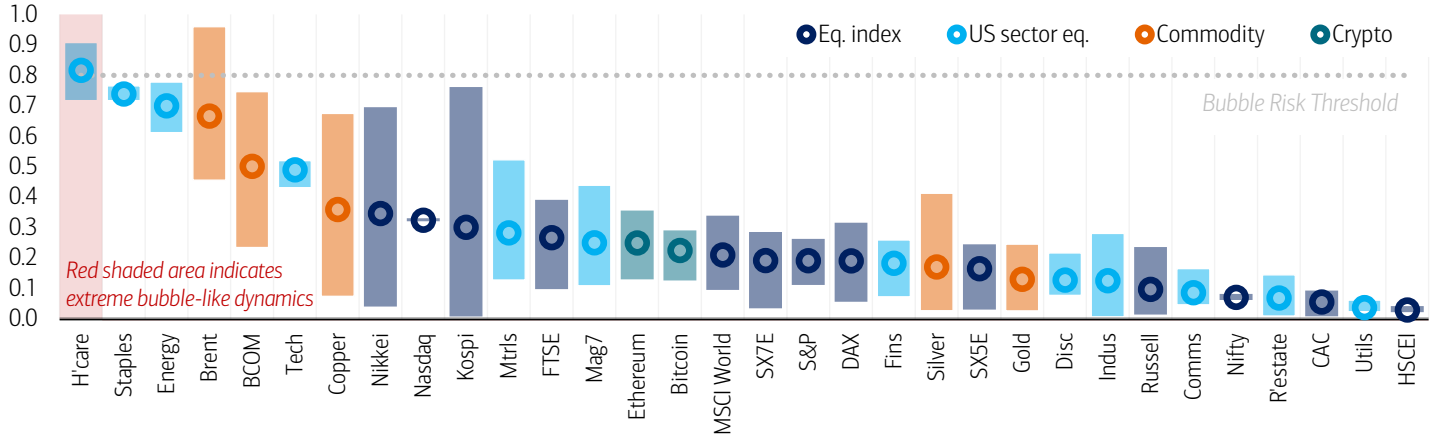
BofA Bubble Risk Indicator Landscape

Defensives bubble as AI & tech wobble

The **BofA Bubble Risk Indicator (BRI)** is a price-based measure designed to detect bubble-like asset dynamics. Inspired by the way the first four moments describe a statistical distribution, the BRI distils an asset's returns, volatility, momentum, and fragility into a single bubble-risk reading on a 0 to 1 scale; 1 represents extreme bubble-like price action while 0 represents none. Historic asset bubbles have exhibited high BRI levels as they formed and peaked (see our 2026 Year Ahead report for more details).

Exhibit 8: The recent wobble in the AI trade and historic rotation to defensive sectors have pushed the BRIs of US Healthcare and Staples stocks towards bubble-risk levels

BofA Bubble Risk indicator (as of 23-Oct-26) across global equity indices, US equity sectors, commodities and crypto (bars: range of short- to long-term sub-indicators)

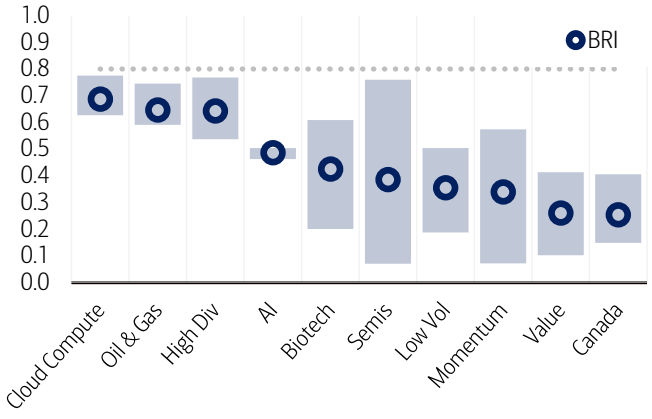


Source: BofA Global Research. Data as of 23-Oct-26. Underlying tickers: SPX, NDX, RTY, SX5E, SX7E, CAC, DAX, UKX, NKY, HSCEI, KOSPI2, NIFTY, MXWD, IXB, IXCPR, IXE, IXM, IXI, IXT, IXR, IXRE, IXU, IXV, IXY, BM7P, BCOM, CO1, XAU, XAG, HG1, XBTUSD, XETUSD. Disclaimer: The indicator identified as the BofA Bubble Risk Indicator is intended to be an indicative metric only and may not be used for reference purposes or as a measure of performance for any financial instrument or contract, or otherwise relied upon by third parties for any other purpose, without the prior written consent of BofA Global Research. This indicator was not created to act as a benchmark.

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Exhibit 9: Cloud computing stocks are showing relatively high (but not extreme) bubble-like dynamics among popular equity themes

Highest BRI readings across popular equity themes (as of 23-Oct-26)

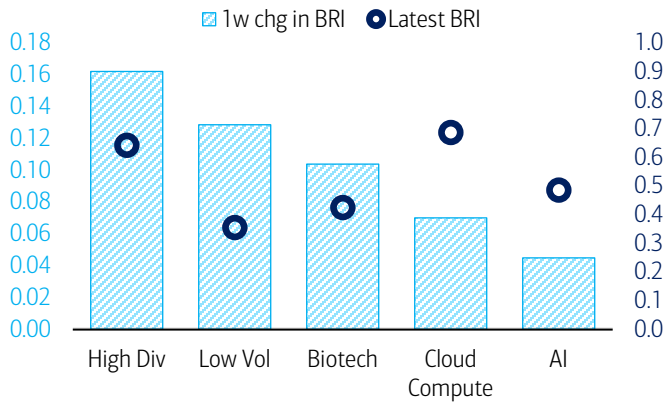


Source: BofA Global Research. Data as of 23-Oct-26. Underlying tickers: CPQNTR, SPSIOPTR, DJUSDIVT, IAIQ, SPSIBITR, ICESEMIT, SP5LVIT, SP500MUT, CRSPLCVT, M1CXBLK. See Disclaimer in Exhibit 8.

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Exhibit 10: High dividend stocks have seen the biggest jump in their Bubble Risk Indicator over the past week among popular equity themes

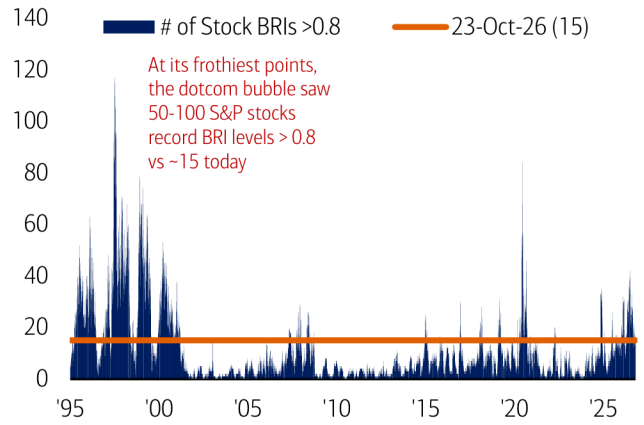
Largest 1w changes in BRI across popular equity themes (as of 23-Oct-26)



Source: BofA Global Research. Data as of 23-Oct-26. Underlying tickers: DJUSDIVT, SP5LVIT, SPSIBITR, CPQNTR, IAIQ. See Disclaimer in Exhibit 8.

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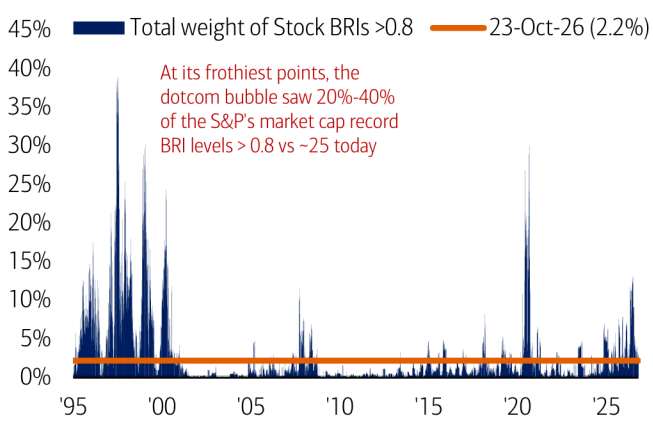
Exhibit 11: Compared with the late 90s dotcom bubble, froth in SPX stocks remains localized, both in terms of number of stocks …
Number of SPX stocks with BRIs above 0.8



Source: BofA Global Research. Data from 1-Jan-95 to 23-Oct-26. Stocks' BRI computed using data since SPX inclusion. See Disclaimer in Exhibit 8.

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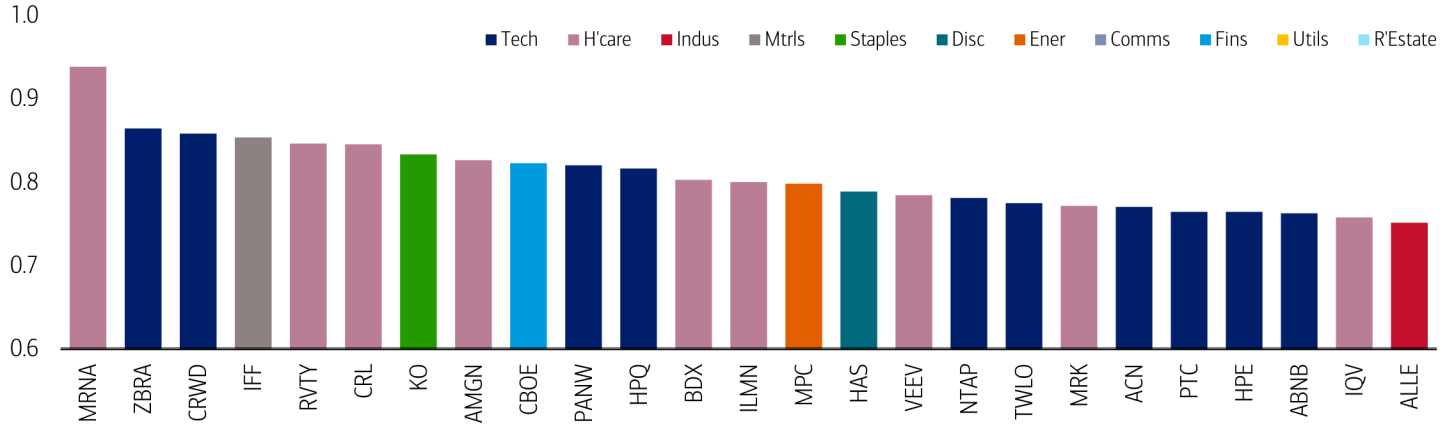
Exhibit 12: … and when measured by total index weight
Total weight of SPX stocks with BRIs above 0.8



Source: BofA Global Research. Data from 1-Jan-95 to 23-Oct-26. Stocks' BRI computed using data since SPX inclusion. See Disclaimer in Exhibit 8.

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Exhibit 13: Stocks like MRNA, ZBRA, CRWD, IFF and RVTY rank highest in terms of their Bubble Risk Indicators amongst S&P 500 members
S&P 500 member stocks with highest BRI reading (as of 23-Oct-26)



Source: BofA Global Research. Data as of 23-Oct-26. See Disclaimer in Exhibit 8. Note that the BRI is a purely price-based metric intended to quantify the degree of bubble-like price action. It is not a fundamental view on the stock and should be used only as a complement to fundamental and positioning-based metrics.

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Exhibit 14: Brazilian election-sensitive and US cybersecurity are amongst the global themes showing bubble-like price action as per their high BRIs
Bubble Risk Indicator on selected BofA Custom Baskets* (as of 23-Oct-26)

Basket	Ticker	BRI
AMRS		
Brazil Election Basket	MLBZELEC	0.94
US Cyber Security Basket	MLCYBRS	0.92
US Software	MLUSSOFT	0.76
US Pharma Hyperscalers Basket	MLURXHYP	0.70
US Commercial Biotech	MLUSCBIO	0.62
US Low Income Spend	MLSPREE	0.60
US Quality Factor	MLUPQUAL	0.60
US AI Orchestra Basket	MLUAIORC	0.57
US TMT Durable Compounders	MLUTMTDC	0.55
US Residual Volatility Factor	MLUPVOLA	0.54
US AI Beneficiaries	MLUSAI	0.53
US Managed Care	MLDIMNGC	0.52
US GLP-1 Disruption Risk	MLXGLP1	0.50
US Exporters	MLUXPORT	0.50
US Stagflation	MLSTGFL8	0.49
US AI Compute	MLUCOMPU	0.48
US Hardware	MLUSHRDW	0.47
US High Quality Yield	MLHQYLD	0.46
US EU Exposed	MLUSEURO	0.44
US Health Care Momentum Factor	MLUPHCMO	0.43
US Efficient Growth	MLUEGROW	0.42
US Copper Exposed Basket	MLUSCOPP	0.41
US National Champions	MLUCHAMP	0.41
US TMT Memory Basket	MLUMEMOR	0.41
US LNG	MLUELNG	0.39
US True Defensives	MLTRUDEF	0.39
US TMT Profitable Growth	MLUTMTPG	0.36
US China Importers	MLCHIMPT	0.36
US Domestic Revenue	MLDOMSTC	0.35
US Consumer China Tariff Exposed	MLCTARIF	0.32
US Energy Momentum Factor	MLUPENMO	0.32
US Defensive Industrials	MLUDINDU	0.31
US Value Factor	MLUPVALU	0.30
US Cyclicals Ex Commods	MLCYCLX	0.30
US TMT Supply Shortage	MLUTMTSP	0.29
US Consensus Large Cap Shorts	MLDISSRT	0.29
US Financials Momentum Factor	MLUPFINM	0.28
US Hard Landing	MLHLAND	0.27
US Data Center Builders	MLDATACB	0.27
US Staples Momentum Factor	MLUPSTMO	0.27
US Discretionary Momentum Factor	MLUPCDMO	0.25
US Building Products	MLUBUILD	0.24
US AI Infrastructure	MLAIINFR	0.24
US Consensus Growth Shorts	MLDIMSGR	0.24
US Transports	MLUTRANS	0.24
US 800v DC Transition	MLU800V	0.23
US Consensus Value Shorts	MLDIMSVL	0.23
US Leisure Travel	MLDILEIS	0.23
US Boosters (Cyclicals)	MLBOOSTR	0.22
US Boomers Spend	MLUBOOM	0.21
US Refinance Risk	MLREFIN	0.21
US SMID Cap Semis	MLSEMISM	0.20
US Generation Z Basket	MLUGENZ	0.19
US Foreign Revenue	MLFORER	0.19
Canada Infrastructure & Defense	MLCAINFR	0.18
US Bond Proxy	MLEBOND	0.17
US Materials Momentum Factor	MLUPMAMO	0.16
US Hard Assets, Low Obsolesce (HALO)	MLUHALO	0.16
US PMI Sensitive Industrials	MLUINDUS	0.15
US Electric Grid Enablers	MLUGRID	0.15
US No Landing	MLNLAND	0.15
US Momentum Factor	MLUPMOMO	0.14
US Commodities Complex	MLCOMMOD	0.14
US AI Adopters	MLUADOPT	0.14
US TMT Defensives	MLUTMTDF	0.14
US High End Consumer	MLDIHEC	0.14
US High Default Risk	MLUHDFLX	0.14
US Retail Signal	MLRETAIL	0.13
US Consumer Goods	MLGOODS	0.13
US Cyclical Industrials ex AI	MLUICXAI	0.13
US Utility Growth Basket	MLUSGUTE	0.13
US Wellness Basket	MLUWELL	0.12
US Soft Landing	MLSLAND	0.12
US Consumer Services	MLSERVE	0.11
US Regulated Utilities	MLUREGU	0.11
US New Construction	MLNCONST	0.11
US Space Race	MLUSPACE	0.10
US Consensus High Beta Shorts	MLDIHBHS	0.10
US Long Term Debt Maturities	MLLTMATS	0.10
US Renewables	MLUSRNEW	0.09
US Crypto Exposed	MLDICRYP	0.09
US Defense Technology	MLUDEFTC	0.09
US Old Economy	MLOLDEC	0.08
US Consensus Small Cap Shorts	MLDIRSRT	0.07
US Industrials Momentum Factor	MLUPINMO	0.06
US Alternative Managers	MLUALTS	0.06
US Private Equity Funds	MLDIPTPE	0.06
US Defense Contractors	MLDEFCON	0.05
US Quantum Computing	MLUQUANT	0.05
US Power Supercycle	MLUSPOWR	0.05
US Beta Factor	MLUPBETA	0.05
US Independent Power Producers (IPPs)	MLUIPPS	0.05
US Water Ecosystem	MLUH2O	0.04
US Defense, Energy, Infra & Security	MLUDEIS	0.04
US NeoCloud Basket	MLUNEOCL	0.04
US Private Credit Proxy	MLPRCRED	0.04
US Drone Ecosystem	MLUDRONE	0.03
US Defense Electronics	MLUDELEC	0.02
US Battery Ecosystem	MLUSBATT	0.02
US TMT Momentum Factor	MLUPTMMO	0.01
US Growth Factor	MLUPGROW	0.01
US Nuclear Energy Exposed	MLUSNUCL	0.00
EMEA		
Oil & Gas ex-Renewables	MLD1OILX	0.73
EU Software	MLESOFTW	0.66
EU Defensives	MLEUDEFS	0.58
UK Consumer	MLD1UKCS	0.57
UK Doms ex-Homebuilders	MLUKDOMX	0.50
EU Max Momo Bottom	MLEMOMOS	0.48
UK Housebuilders	MLUKHOME	0.42
EU Consensus Shorts	MLD1MSEU	0.38
UK Domestic Names	MLUKDOMS	0.36
EU Steel	MLESTEEL	0.34
EU Exposed to US Consumer	MLEUSCON	0.33
EU Stagflation	MLEUSTAG	0.31
EU Semis & Semicaps	MLD1EUSM	0.30
UK M&A Candidates	MLUKMNAC	0.29
EU New Energy Order	MLEUNEOE	0.29
EU AI Adopters	MLEADOPT	0.28
Gold Miners	MLD1GLDM	0.28
EU Copper Miners	MLEUCOPP	0.28
EU Memory	MLEUBYTE	0.26
EU Cyclical Exp to US	MLECYCUS	0.26
EU Consumer Discretionary	MLEUCONS	0.26
EU Travel Basket	MLD1TRAV	0.26
EU Cyclical Chems	MLECCHEM	0.26
EU Tariff Exposed	MLETARIF	0.24
EU High USD Exposure	MLEUAMER	0.23
EU Russia Exposed	MLEURUSS	0.23
EU M&A	MLEUMNAC	0.22
EU Power Grids	MLEUGRID	0.22
EU AI Power Surge	MLESURGE	0.19
UK Banks	MLD1UKBK	0.18
EU Cyclicals	MLEUCYCL	0.18
EU Defense Electronics	MLEDEFEL	0.17
EU Short Cycle Industrial	MLEINSCY	0.17
EU HALO Basket	MLEUHALO	0.17
EU HY Debt	MLEUDEBT	0.17
EU Consensus Longs	MLD1LSEU	0.16
Italian Banks	MLEUITBK	0.16
EU Capital Goods	MLD1CAPG	0.16
Industrial Manufacturing	MLEINMAN	0.16
European Reflation	MLD1REFL	0.16
EU Max Momo Top	MLEMOMOL	0.13
EU stocks China expo	MLD1CHEX	0.13
EU Security DEIS	MLEUDEIS	0.12
EU European Domestics	MLEUDOMS	0.12
EU Most Gas Exp	MLD1GASX	0.10
EU Defense	MLD1DEFE	0.10
EU Ukraine Recovery	MLERBUKR	0.10
EU Sovereign Priority	MLEUSOVR	0.09
German Infrastructure	MLEGEINF	0.09
EU Renewable Utilities	MLEURNEW	0.08
EU Defence Exposed	MLEINDEF	0.08
Germany Domestic	MLEGEDOM	0.07
French Domestics	MLD1FRAN	0.06
EU Autos	MLEUAUTO	0.03
EU Luxury	MLEULUXG	0.03
APAC		
Japan Defensives	MLHKJPDF	0.70
APAC Shipping	MLAPSHIP	0.67
JPY Winners Appreciation	MLHKJPYA	0.57
Japan Retail	MLAPJRE	0.54
APAC 5G	MLHKAP5G	0.49
Taiwan AI basket	MLHKTWAI	0.45
Japan Electric Power	MLJPTPEL	0.41
AxJ Inflation	MLHKAXIF	0.38
Korea Tourism	MLHKKRTM	0.37
Japan Wage Growth	MLHKJPWG	0.36
APAC AI Beneficiaries	MLHKAPAI	0.36
JPY Winners Depreciation	MLHKJPFX	0.32
Japan NISA	MLHKNISA	0.31
Japan Mgmt Transformation	MLAPJACA	0.30
Japan Inflation	MLHKJPIF	0.28
Japan Domestic Upcycle	MLAPJDUB	0.28
China Technology Localization	MLHKCTLC	0.27
APAC Smart Glasses	MLAPSMGL	0.26
APAC Airline	MLHKFLYA	0.24
APAC World Cup	MLAPWCUP	0.23
Korea Battery	MLKRBATT	0.22
APAC Oil exposed	MLAPOIL	0.22
Japan Cyclicals	MLHKJPCY	0.21
Greater China Robotic	MLAPHUMA	0.21
APAC Petrochem	MLAPCHEM	0.20
Japan Industrials	MLAPJPIN	0.18
China High Dividend Yield	MLAPCHDV	0.17
Japan Fiscal Impact	MLAPGEJP	0.17
Korea Corporate Reform	MLHKKRPB	0.17
China SOEs	MLHKZSOE	0.15
Japan Engagement	MLAPJPAT	0.14
China AI Supply Chain	MLAPAISC	0.13
China Little Giants	MLHKCHLG	0.12
Australian Mining	MLHKAUMN	0.12
Japan High EM Exposure	MLHKHICH	0.12
APAC Gold	MLAPGOLD	0.12
Japan Exporter to the US	MLAPJPEP	0.12
Japan GPIF	MLHKGPIF	0.09
Korea Export ex Auto/Tech	MLKRREXP	0.07
China Robotics & AI	MLAPCHAI	0.07
Korea Holdco	MLAPKRHO	0.06
Korea Defense	MLHKKRDF	0.06
Japan Corp Reform	MLHKJPRE	0.06
APAC Nuclear	MLHKNUCL	0.06
Japan Defense	MLAPJDEF	0.05
China Consumer Old	MLHKCHCO	0.05
Japan Tariff Exposed	MLAPJPTR	0.05
APAC Coal	MLAPCOAL	0.05
China Property	MLCNPROP	0.04
China Consumer New	MLAPHKCN	0.03
Japan Sanaenomics	MLAPJPSA	0.03
APAC AI Infrastructure	MLAPAIIF	0.03
China Consumption Stimulus	MLAPCHST	0.02
China National Brand	MLHKCBVM	0.02
APAC EV	MLHKAPRN	0.02
China Internet	MLHKCHIH	0.01
Macau Gaming	MLHKMCGM	0.01
China OPenClaw	MLAPCLAW	0.01
China Tariff	MLHKRPW2	0.01
HK Dual listed H-shares	MLHKPREM	0.01
China Anti Involution Basket	MLAPANTI	0.00

Source: BofA Global Research. Data as of 23-Oct-26. *Disclaimer: These BofA baskets are proprietary baskets structured and maintained by the BofA Securities trading desk. For more details on these baskets, please contact the team. See BRI disclaimer in Exhibit 8.

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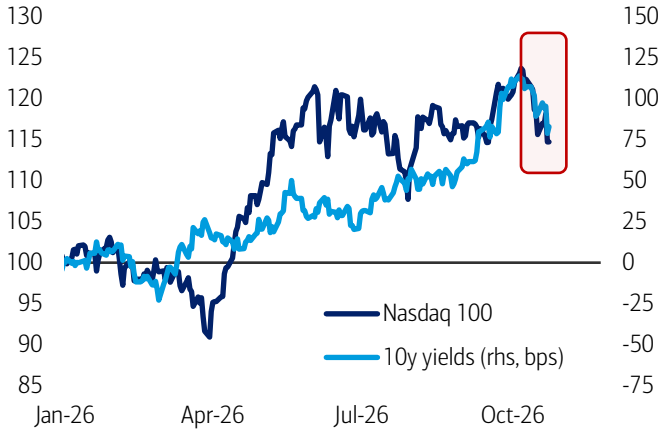
Defensive bubbles blew in Dotcom era too

As concerns around the AI trade continued to weigh on US tech last week, the resulting market dynamics reinforced many of our recent observations and views:

- **AI down, rates down reaction function**: AI-driven weakness in recent weeks has traded as a growth shock (as we argued last week in the 20-Oct-26 GEVI), with yields falling alongside equities (Exhibit 15). Price action on 22-Oct was a striking example of this reaction function, with 10y yields dropping more than 16bps as the Nasdaq declined nearly 3%.

- **NDX-SPX vol spread expands again**: The spread between NDX and SPX vol, both implied and realized, has widened again in recent weeks (Exhibit 16), highlighting the Nasdaq's asymmetric reactivity to the AI trade relative to the S&P. This continues to support our preference for owning Nasdaq over S&P in both delta and vol formats, as the AI bubble continues to build (see How to own the AI race report for more details).

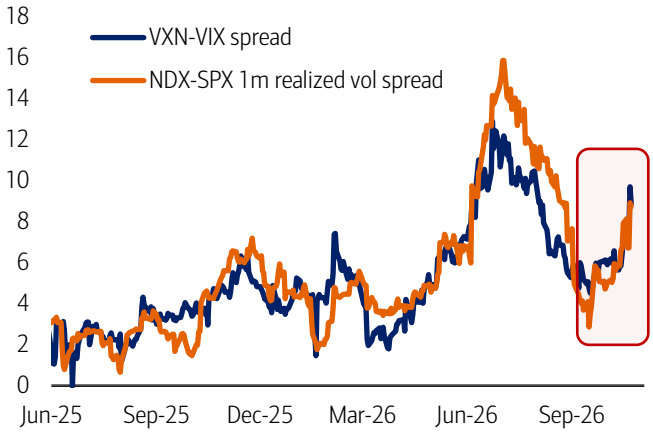
Exhibit 15: AI-driven weakness in recent weeks has traded as a growth shock and seen yields move lower with equities, with 10y yields falling by 16bps on 22-Oct as the Nasdaq declined nearly 3%
Nasdaq 100 YTD performance and YTD change in US 10y yields



Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg. Data from 1-jan-26 to 23-Oct-26.

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Exhibit 16: The NDX-SPX vol spread has widened again in recent weeks, both on an implied and realized basis, highlighting the Nasdaq's asymmetric reactivity to the AI trade vs the S&P
VXN-VIX spread and NDX-SPX 1m realized vol spread

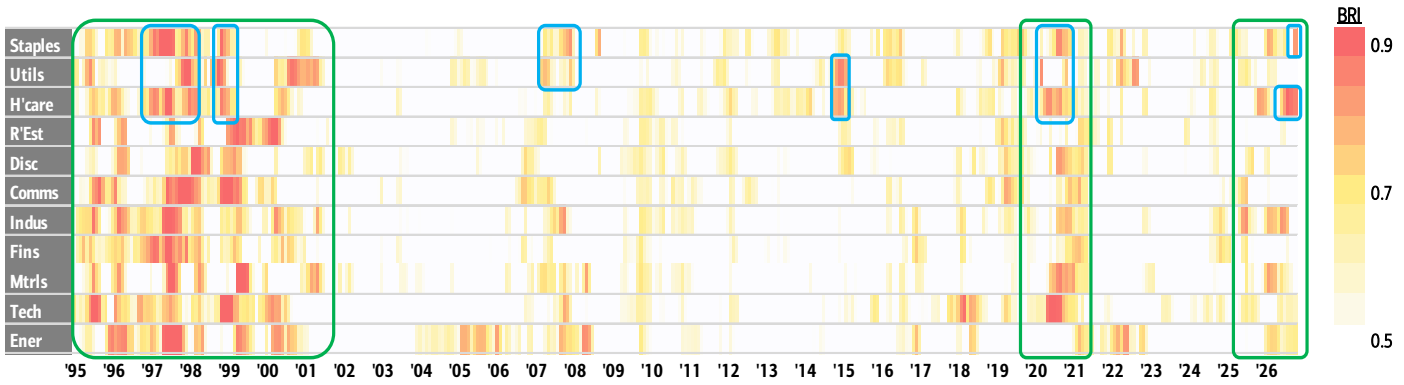


Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg. Data as of 1-Jun-25 to 23-Oct-26.

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- **In bubble-like markets, even "defensives" can froth**: The historic rotation into US healthcare and staples stocks has pushed their BRI levels towards bubble-risk levels, with both now among the highest globally (Exhibit 8), perhaps paradoxically given their *defensive* status. However, BRI trends across S&P sectors suggest that structurally bubble-like markets can create frothy dynamics in sectors where fundamentals may not, with defensives (and most other sectors) having similarly high BRIs during the late 90s Dotcom bubble and post-COVID melt-up period (Exhibit 17). In this regard, the emergence of bubble-like dynamics in healthcare and staples today provides further evidence for our broader view that markets are moving towards an increasingly reflexive and boom-bust prone regime.

Exhibit 17: BRI trends across S&P sectors over the past 30yrs reveal that structurally bubble-like markets can create frothy dynamics in sectors where fundamentals may not, with defensives (and most other sectors) having similarly high BRIs in the late 90s Dotcom bubble and post-COVID melt-up period
BofA Bubble Risk Indicator levels* on S&P 500 sectors since 1995



Source: BofA Global Research. Data from Jan-95 to Oct-26. *Sector-wise monthly maximum BRI level. Sectors are defined as per the Global Industry Classification Standard, along with re-classification of certain companies (primarily those not in tech that are largely internet/tech driven, e.g., Tesla, Amazon, Uber etc.).

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Nasdaq lookback puts contingent on rates lower remain our AI hedge of choice

Given further evidence last week of an equity down, rates reaction function in periods of AI stress, we continue to favour NDX max lookback puts contingent on 10y rates lower as a targeted hedge against a more prolonged AI unwind (see 13-Oct-26 GEVI for further analysis on this trade).

While rates have moved modestly lower and growing interest in the trade has pushed the correlation entry point higher since publication, we continue to find the trade attractive for two reasons: (i) rates are unlikely to have fallen as far as they would in a more prolonged AI unwind, and (ii) the outright cost of the hybrid remains attractive relative to other longer-dated hedges. For those looking for more capped protection with the benefit of a lower premium outlay, NDX expanding put spreads contingent on rates lower offer an attractive alternative, in our view.

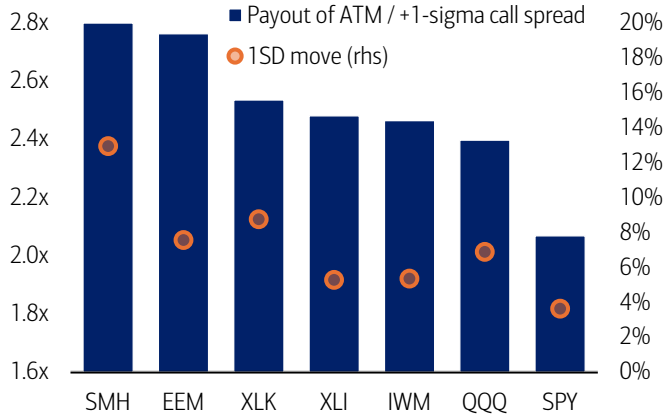
Attractive ETF & single-stock call spreads for a post-catalyst risk-on shift

In the near term, the passage of key catalysts including megacap earnings, the Oct FOMC meeting and midterm elections could serve as a "clearing event" for risk into year-end and catalyse a bullish shift in sentiment. For investors who have taken down risk in recent weeks, the asymmetry of call spreads can offer an attractive way to participate in a potential year-end rally with limited risk.

Among ETFs, call spreads on SMH (semis ETF) and EEM (EM equity ETF) offer attractive payout ratios for capturing a one standard deviation move higher by December expiry (Exhibit 18). Among tech-oriented single stocks, Dec call spreads on TMUS and WDC provide the highest payout ratios for capturing a 1-sigma move higher (Exhibit 19). Although absolute payout ratios may appear modest, moving the lower strike further out-of-the-money would increase the potential payoff.

Exhibit 18: SMH and EEM offer the highest call spread payout ratios for a 1-sigma move higher by Dec expiry, among options-liquid ETFs that have sold off since the 6-Oct Nasdaq peak

Highest payout ratios of Dec26 ATMs / 1-sigma upside call spreads among options-liquid ETFs

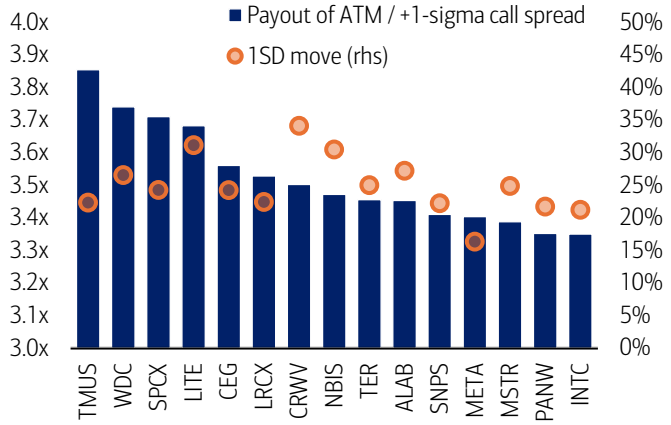


Source: BofA Global Research. Indicative payout ratios as of 26-Oct-26. *ETFs that have negative returns from 6-Oct (NDX peak) and at least $50m of daily notional options volume. 1SD based on trailing 1m realized vol of daily returns.

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Exhibit 19: TMUS and WDC offer the highest call spread payout ratios for a 1-sigma move higher by Dec expiry, among options-liquid ETFs that have sold off since the 6-Oct Nasdaq peak

Highest payout ratios of Dec26 ATMs / 1-sigma upside call spreads among options-liquid Nasdaq 100 stocks



Source: BofA Global Research. Indicative payout ratios as of 26-Oct-26. * Stocks that have negative returns from 6-Oct (NDX peak) and at least $50m of daily notional options volume. 1SD based on trailing 1m realized vol of daily returns.

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

The age of idiosyncratic risk: A tale of stock fragility and earnings volatility

The view: US earnings vol premium has risen, but realised moves have risen even more, with the underpricing particularly pronounced among megacap vols. Europe shows the opposite dynamic: implied earnings risk is close to historical extremes, yet only around a third of stocks have recently delivered moves larger than options anticipated.

Single-stock fragility remains a defining feature of equity markets in the US as well as Europe. Elevated single-stock volatility suggests that this is likely to remain an important feature through year-end. Indeed, 3m ATM weighted-average stock volatility is currently 38% for the US SPX Top 50, around 2.5x equivalent index volatility, and 31% in Europe, (~1.8x the SX5E index equivalent). Exhibit 20 shows that the frequency of fragility events, when individual stocks experience outsized moves relative to their trailing volatility, has remained elevated in 2026, putting Europe on track for one of its top five biggest years for such fragility events.

Earnings announcements remain the most important scheduled information events for individual stocks and have been an important source of the outsized moves seen in recent years. To assess how well stock options anticipate earnings-related risk, we compare the excess implied volatility for an earnings event with the excess volatility that is subsequently realised. We find that:

- **US earnings implied vol has risen but remains 'cheap':** The excess implied volatility around US stock earnings has increased materially in recent years. Realised earnings moves, however, have increased even more, leaving stock option markets in aggregate underpricing volatility ultimately delivered around results (Exhibit 21).

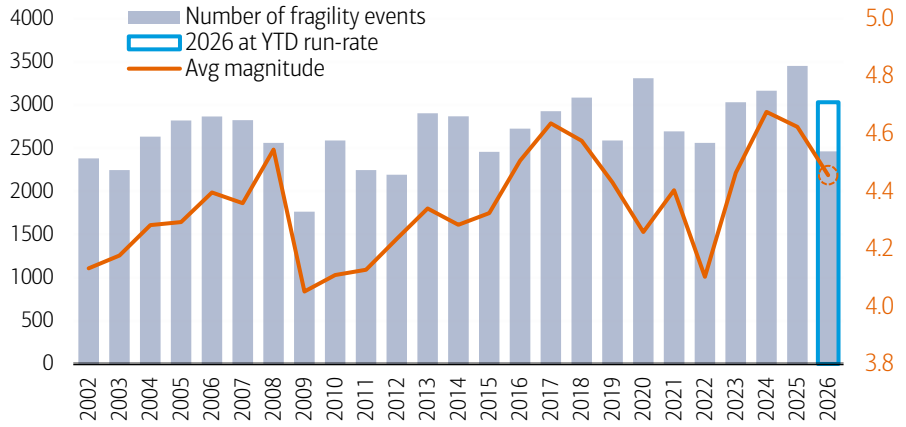
- **Megacap US stock options offer better value (than average stock) over earnings:** The gap between realised and implied earnings volatility has recently been particularly pronounced for index-weighted than equal-weighted stocks, consistent with the unusually large earnings-day moves seen across US megacaps in recent quarters (Exhibit 22). Consistent with this, roughly two-thirds of SPX Top 50 market capitalisation (more than half by count) has recently delivered earnings moves larger than those implied beforehand by options, a 98th percentile reading (Exhibit 24).

- **European earnings vol premium has widened to near unprecedented levels:** The excess volatility priced around European earnings has risen to its 94th percentile (Exhibit 25). Unlike in the US, this richness is not restricted to the largest stock options: equal- and index-weighted measures tell a similar story (Exhibit 26). Indeed, earnings risk remains high versus history in Europe when measured as a share of the level of idiosyncratic risk (Exhibit 27).

- **European earnings vols 'rich', in contrast to US:** Europe's higher implied earnings premium has not been matched by realised moves. Only around 1/3rd of European stocks, and a similarly low share by market cap, have recently realised earnings moves larger than stock options implied beforehand (Exhibit 28). In other words, investors have recently been paying an unusually high premium for European earnings risk without subsequently seeing commensurately large realised moves.

Exhibit 20: While last year's record levels of stock fragility set a high hurdle, 2026 is tracking close on a pro-rata basis. The broader trend remains intact, with European single-stock fragility continuing to rise, underscoring growing idiosyncratic risk across the region

No. & average magnitude of fragility events (sigma move magnitude > 3)* for STOXX 600 names.

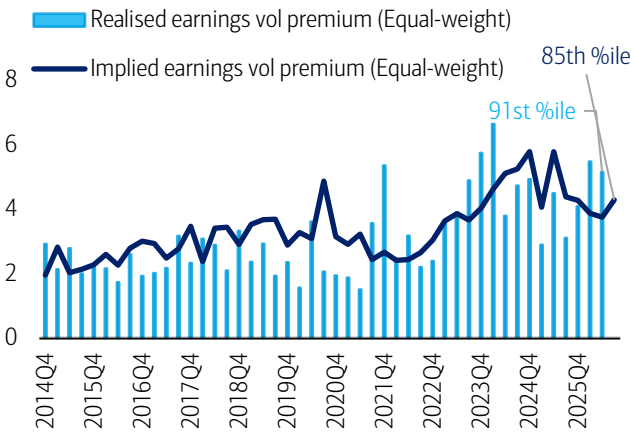


Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg. Data from 31-Dec-01 to 23-Oct-26. Components of index kept fixed at the start of the calendar year. *"Sigma move" is measured by dividing a stock's 1d return by its 21d trailing volatility. It is a measure of how large a shock is vs its risk projected by recent volatility and is one measure of price "fragility".

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Exhibit 21: The earnings excess volatility premium implied has grown for US names, but has recently been realizing higher still…

Earnings excess volatility premium (implied and realised, in vol pts) for equal-weighted SPX Top 50 names.

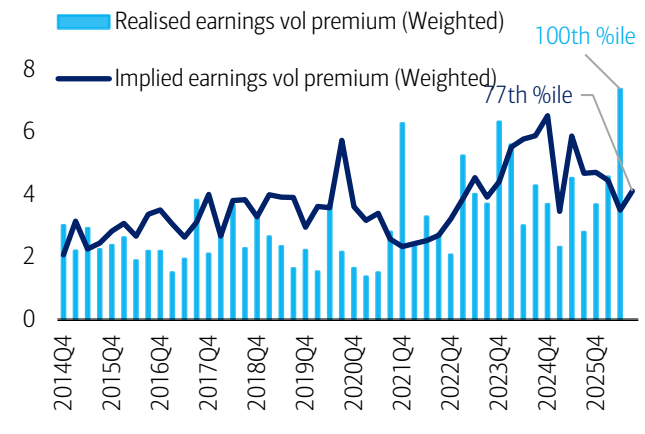


Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg. Data from Jan-15 to Oct-26. *Please refer to the "Key Definitions box" for calculation methodology details

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Exhibit 22: … particularly looking at market-cap weighted stocks, as larger cap names have experienced the largest earnings day moves

Earnings excess volatility premium (implied and realised, in vol pts) for index-weighted SPX Top 50 names.

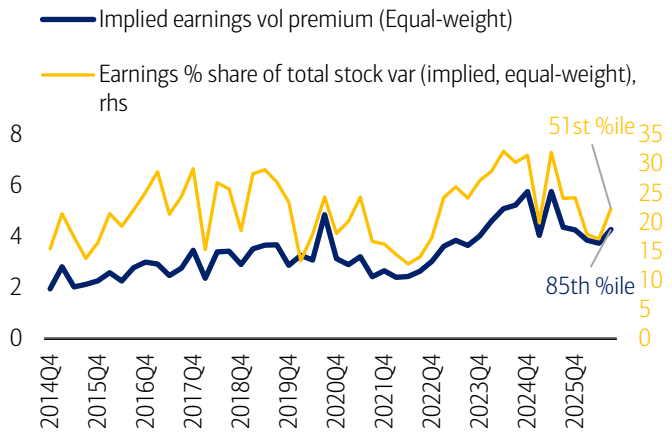


Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg. Data from Jan-15 to Oct-26. *Please refer to the "Key Definitions box" for calculation methodology details

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Exhibit 23: While the US stocks' earnings excess volatility premium has grown in absolute terms, it hasn't as a proportion of the total stock volatility

Implied excess earnings risk for equal-weighted SPX Top 50 names (lhs, in vol points, and on rhs as a % of total stock variance).

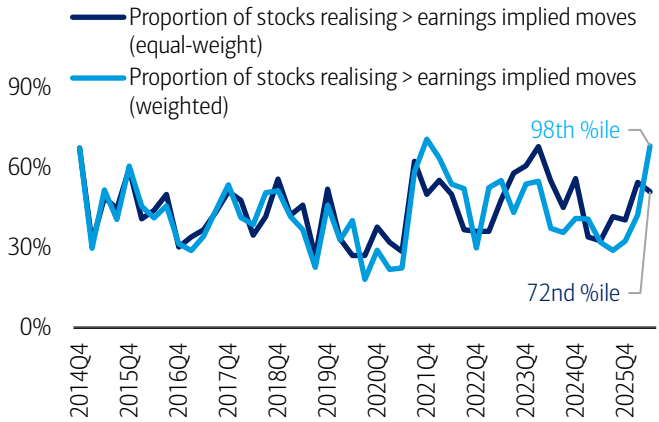


Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg. Data from Jan-15 to Oct-26. *Please refer to the "Key Definitions box" for calculation methodology details

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Exhibit 24: Even as stock vols and earnings moves have been rising, more than half the US single names by count (>two-thirds by market cap, 98th %ile) have recently realized larger moves on earnings than previously implied

Proportion of SPX Top 50 names realizing a larger move on earnings than was previously implied by option prices.

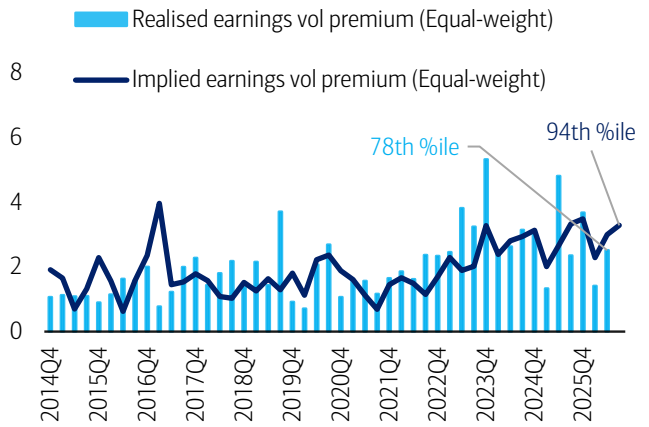


Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg. Data from Jan-15 to Oct-26. Proportion of stocks whose realized earnings-day move exceed the implied move (measured as the absolute return on the earnings release date or the following date). Consistent with the previous exhibits, the implied move is estimated from the excess volatility attributable to the earnings release day and converted into a one-day expected move.

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Exhibit 25: European stocks are pricing in historically high levels of excess risk on account of earnings, but this risk isn't realizing yet

Earnings excess volatility premium (implied and realised, in vol pts) for equal-weighted SX5E names.

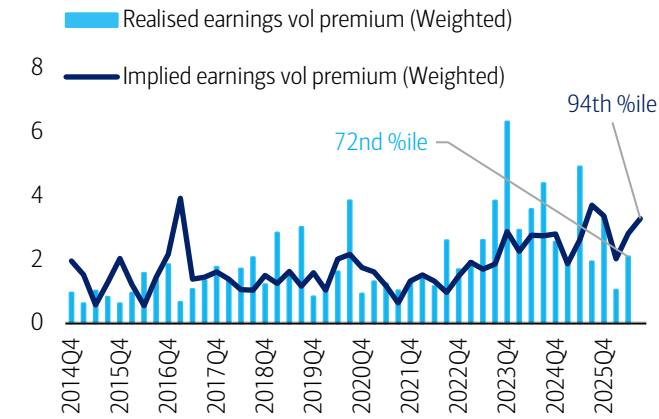


Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg. Data from Jan-15 to Oct-26. *Please refer to the "Key Definitions box" for calculation methodology details

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Exhibit 26: The earnings risk implied remains unaffected by stock weights, and is largely independent of stock market capitalisation

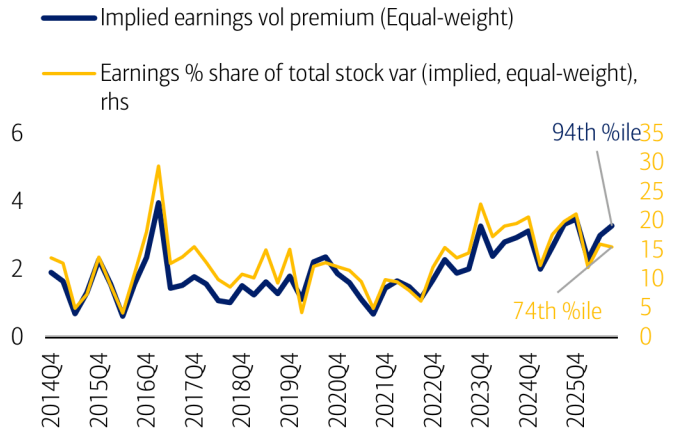
Earnings excess volatility premium (implied and realised, in vol pts) for index-weighted SX5E names.



Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg. Data from Jan-15 to Oct-26. *Please refer to the "Key Definitions box" for calculation methodology details

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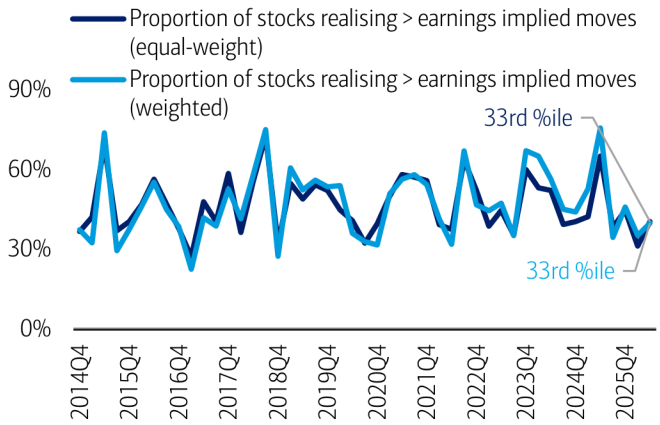
Exhibit 27: European earnings vol premium looks historically high, even once normalised for the level of volatility…
Implied excess earnings risk for equal-weighted SX5E names (lhs, in vol points, and on rhs as a % of total stock variance).



Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg. Data from Jan-15 to Oct-26. *Please refer to the "Key Definitions box" for calculation methodology details

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Exhibit 28: Only about a third of European stocks have recently realised larger moves than the options had previously anticipated
Proportion of SX5E names realizing a larger move on earnings than was previously implied by option prices.



Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg. Data from Jan-15 to Oct-26. Proportion of stocks whose realized earnings-day move exceeds the implied move (measured as the absolute return on the earnings release date or the following date). Consistent with the previous exhibits, the implied move is estimated from the excess volatility attributable to the earnings release day and converted into a one-day expected move.

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Key definitions:

Earnings excess implied volatility premium: For each stock, the earnings excess implied volatility premium is calculated as the difference between the observed implied vol of the maturity containing the earnings release and an estimate of what the implied vol would have been without the earnings event. This estimated fair value is obtained by interpolating between neighboring maturities. The implied vols used to calculate this measure are snapped 10 business days before the expiry immediately preceding the maturity containing the earnings release. Individual stock results are then aggregated using both equal-weighted and market-cap-weighted approaches.

Earnings excess realised volatility premium: For each stock, the earnings excess realised volatility premium is calculated as the difference between the observed realised vol, measured over the same window as the implied vol, and the realised vol over that same window after excluding the return on the earnings release day. Individual stock results are then aggregated using both equal-weighted and market-cap-weighted approaches.

Earnings share of total stock implied & realised variance: This represents the fraction of total stock variance attributable to the earnings event, calculated as 1 minus the ratio of variance excluding the earnings impact to total variance.

Frequently asked questions about the BofA Bubble Risk Indicator (BRI)

In our 2026 Year Ahead report, we introduced the BofA Bubble Risk Indicator (BRI), a price-based measure designed to detect bubble-like instability across financial assets. Given strong client interest, we are now adding a weekly one-page BRI update to the GEVI (see earlier pages). This update will track BRI levels across major markets and asset classes, highlight pockets of equities exhibiting the most froth, and call out recent increases in bubble-like price action. Below, we address some of the most frequently asked questions about the BRI.

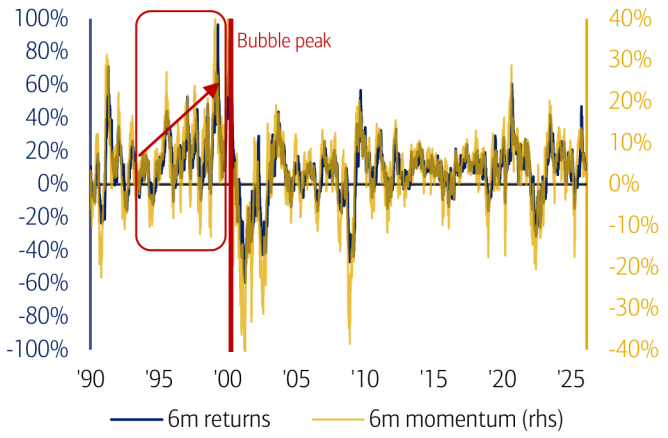
The BofA Bubble Risk Indicator is intended to be an indicative metric only and may not be used for reference purposes or as a measure of performance for any financial instrument or contract, or otherwise relied upon by third parties for any other purpose, without the prior written consent of BofA Global Research. The BRI was not created to act as a benchmark.

1. How does the BRI quantify 'bubble risk'?

A defining feature of historical asset bubbles is that volatility tends to rise alongside prices. Building on this observation and drawing inspiration from how the four statistical moments characterize a distribution, the BRI quantifies bubble risk using the first four moments of an asset's price action: (i) returns, (ii) realized volatility, (iii) price momentum[1], and (iv) fragility/convexity.[2]

These four moments typically become elevated during the frothiest phases of asset bubbles, reflecting the influence of exuberant sentiment, one-sided positioning and imbalanced supply-demand dynamics on price action. The late 90s dotcom bubble in the Nasdaq provides a clear and pertinent illustration of these dynamics (Exhibit 29 & Exhibit 30).

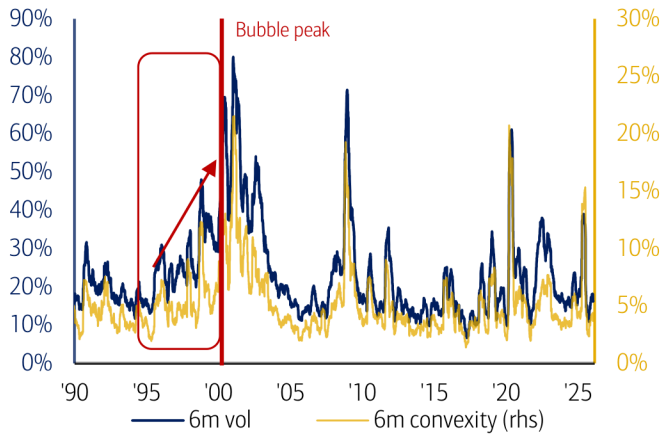
Exhibit 29: Both price returns and price momentum of the Nasdaq rose as the dotcom bubble inflated
NDX 6m price returns and 6m price momentum



Source: BofA Global Research. Data from 1-Jan-90 to 16-Jan-26.

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Exhibit 30: Nasdaq's vol and fragility also rose into the peak of the dotcom bubble as tech stock price rose
NDX 6m realized vol and 6m realized convexity



Source: BofA Global Research. Data from 1-Jan-90 to 16-Jan-26.

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2. How is the BRI constructed?

The BRI is constructed as an average of three sub-indicators: a short-term, medium-term, and long-term measure. Each sub-indicator ranges from 0 to 1. Using multiple time horizons allows the indicator to capture bubble-risk dynamics that can develop at different speeds.

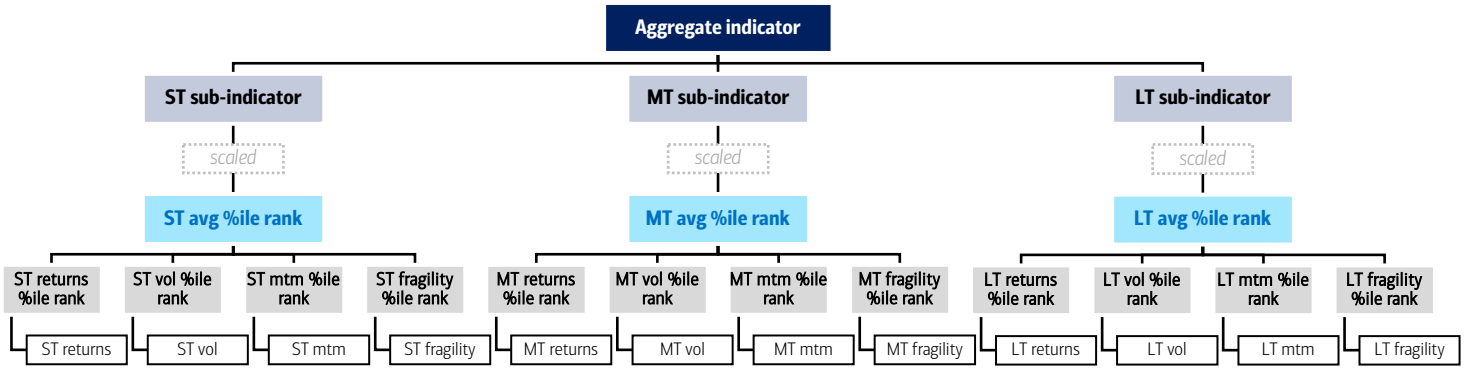
[1] X-month price momentum = % distance of the current price from the X-month moving average price

[2] X-month fragility/convexity = X-month realized vol – X-month realized mean absolute deviation

Each sub-indicator aims to capture how stretched an asset's four moments (returns, vol, momentum, and fragility) are relative to the asset's own history, and is computed as the average of each of these four moments' percentile ranks vs history.[3] However, given detection of bubble-like behaviour is the primary aim of the indicator, we condition this average percentile rank on periods when the asset is rallying by scaling it up or down depending on how positive or negative returns are.[4]

Exhibit 31 summarizes the construction of the aggregate indicator and its microstructure.

Exhibit 31: The aggregate indicator is an average of 3 sub-indicators that capture short-, medium- and long-term price dynamics. Each sub-indicator is computed as a scaled average percentile rank of the four metrics (returns, vol, momentum & fragility)
Construction summary of BofA Bubble Risk Indicator



Source: BofA Global Research. ST, MT & LT refer to short-, medium- & long-term; 'mtm' refers to momentum component; '%-ile rank' refers to percentile rank.

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3. What is a 'high' BRI reading and what are its implications?

Since the BRI is defined on a 0 to 1 scale, assets with readings approaching 1 are exhibiting increasingly bubble-like price action. How close to 1? While it is difficult to specify a universal threshold given the plethora of asset-specific dynamics that can present in markets, we find that BRI levels above 0.8 (i.e., top quintile) provide a useful rule of thumb beyond which bubble risks are likely elevated.

Tactically, high BRI readings tend to signal asymmetric downside risk in the near-term (higher risk of the bubble 'popping'), which we demonstrate empirically later in this section. However, rather than treating the BRI as an explicit sell signal ("get out"), which can risk major in a bubble, we find the BRI best positioned as a cautionary tool to add asymmetric protection/equity replacement ("watch out").

4. What assets can the BRI be computed on?

Given the BRI relies only on price-based inputs, it can be computed on any asset with a sufficient history of daily price data. Indeed, by inferring sentiment and positioning from price action, the BRI can be applied to assets without explicit fundamental valuation methodologies (e.g., commodities) or those with opaque positioning visibility.

5. What has the BRI looked like in past asset bubbles?

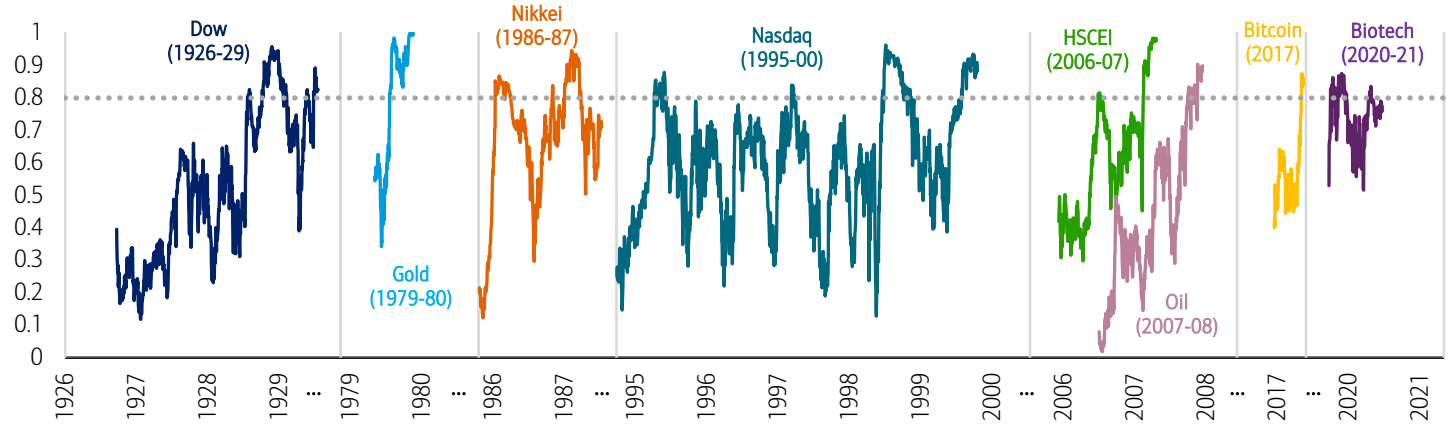
Exhibit 32 demonstrates what the BRI framework would have looked like when applied to eight historically well-recognized asset bubbles. As these bubbles formed, increasingly stretched returns, vol, momentum, and fragility pushed BRI readings towards 1. Indeed, seven of the eight bubbles saw their peaks concurrent to a BRI reading above 0.8.

[3] Sub-indicator parameters in this report: (i) short-term = 3m moments vs 1y %ile rank lookback, (ii) medium-term = 6m moments vs 3y %ile rank lookback, (iii) long-term = 1y moments vs 5y %ile rank lookback. These parameters are for illustrative purposes and may differ in their efficacy depending on the dynamics of the asset being analyzed.

[4] Scaling factor ranges between 0 & 1. It is computed using a logistic function transformation of the trailing return (tenor based on sub-indicator). Highly positive returns give a factor of ~1 and highly negative returns give a factor of ~0.

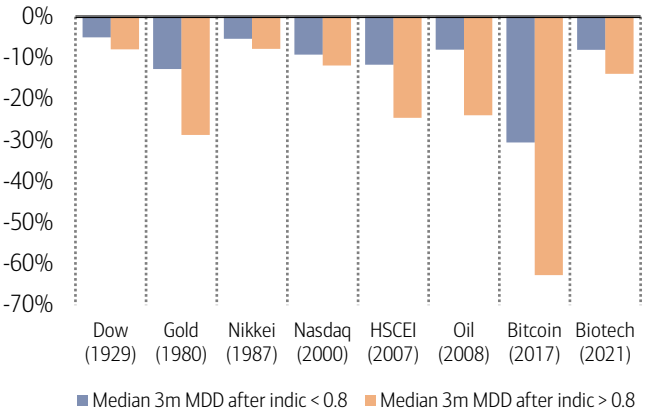
The forward distribution of returns during these bubbles conditional on the BRI would have shown higher near-term downside risk after the BRI breached 0.8 (Exhibit 33), with broadly similar upside potential (Exhibit 34).

Exhibit 32: Looking at eight historical asset bubbles from a distributional lens using the BRI methodology reveals increasingly elevated returns, vol, momentum and fragility in the asset bubble formation process, as seen by rising levels of the indicator towards 1
BofA Bubble Risk Indicator during historical asset bubbles



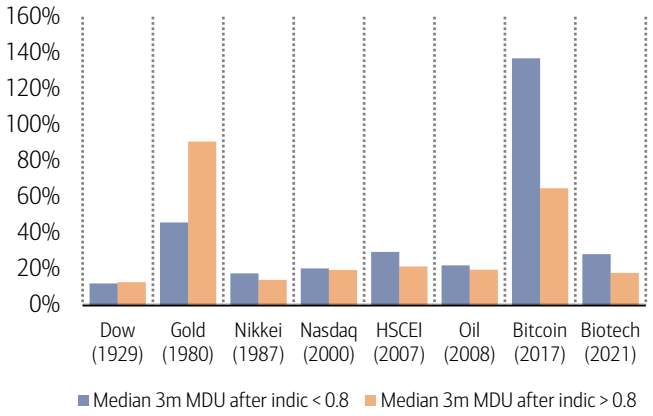
Source: BofA Global Research. Data from Jan-1926 to Feb-2021. Underlying Bloomberg tickers: INDU for Dow (Oct-1926 to Sep-1929), XAU for Gold (Jul-1979 to Jan-1980), NKY for Nikkei (Jan-1986 to Oct-1987), NDX for Nasdaq (Jan-1995 to Mar-2000), HSCEI for HSCEI (Jun-2006 to Oct-2007), CO1 for Oil (Jan-2007 to Jul-2008), XBTUSD for Bitcoin (Jul-2017 to Dec-2017), SPSIBI for Biotech (May-2020 to Feb-2021).
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Exhibit 33: The median 3m max draw-down following indicator readings above 0.8 would have been more adverse than when below 0.8 during historical asset bubbles
Median 3m max draw-down during historical asset bubbles (i) after indicator < 0.8, (ii) after indicator >= 0.8



Source: BofA Global Research. Underlying tickers / date ranges: INDU for Dow (Oct-1926 to Sep-1929), XAU for Gold (Jul-1979 to Jan-1980), NKY for Nikkei (Jan-1986 to Oct-1987), NDX for Nasdaq (Jan-1995 to Mar-2000), HSCEI for HSCEI (Jun-2006 to Oct-2007), CO1 for Oil (Jan-2007 to Jul-2008), XBTUSD for Bitcoin (Jul-2017 to Dec-2017), SPSIBI for Biotech (May-2020 to Feb-2021).
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Exhibit 34: The median 3m max draw-up would have been similar at both high and low indicator readings, suggesting that de-risking completely following high indicator levels can risk
Median 3m max draw-up during historical asset bubbles (i) after indicator < 0.8, (ii) after indicator >= 0.8



Source: BofA Global Research. Underlying tickers / date ranges: INDU for Dow (Oct-1926 to Sep-1929), XAU for Gold (Jul-1979 to Jan-1980), NKY for Nikkei (Jan-1986 to Oct-1987), NDX for Nasdaq (Jan-1995 to Mar-2000), HSCEI for HSCEI (Jun-2006 to Oct-2007), CO1 for Oil (Jan-2007 to Jul-2008), XBTUSD for Bitcoin (Jul-2017 to Dec-2017), SPSIBI for Biotech (May-2020 to Feb-2021).
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6. Can an asset with a high BRI reading not be in a bubble?

Yes. One of the risks stemming from the BRI's exclusive use of price data is instances of 'false positives' when the indicator appears stressed, but the asset doesn't appear to be in a bubble based on other metrics. For example, semiconductor stocks exhibited frothy behaviour in the immediate aftermath of ChatGPT's release in Nov-22 but also saw a fundamental shift and expansion of their business model in the AI era.

Another scenario of a high BRI level that may not point to a bubble is in the immediate aftermath of an exogenous shock (e.g., COVID), where vol/fragility remain high and prices are retracing their drawdown. In such cases, the interpretation of a high BRI level requires additional context.

7. Can an asset in a bubble have a low BRI reading?

Yes. A related limitation of the BRI's reliance on price data is the implicit assumption that the asset bubble in question would result in historically elevated instability. While the typical evolution of a bubble sees this happen as stretched positioning and exuberance translate into volatile & fragile rallies with high momentum into the peak, outlier cases where the bubble peak sees the bull run end in a whimper can occur and are a challenge for the BRI (e.g., the Nikkei bubble in the 1980s, which saw its most unstable rally earlier rather than later).

8. How can one use the short-term to long-term sub-indicators of the BRI?

As discussed above, the BRI aggregates short-term, medium-term, and long-term sub-indicators to capture asset price dynamics across multiple horizons. In addition to examining the sub-indicators to understand shorter vs longer-term trends, we also find the range across sub-indicators provides a confidence level on the BRI reading, with tighter ranges providing higher confidence. For example, a 0.7 BRI reading is likely more informative when the sub-indicators span 0.6 to 0.8 than when they range from 0.4 to 1.0, where disagreement across horizons suggests greater uncertainty.

9. What other indicators can help confirm elevated bubble risk?

At its core, the BRI is simply a parsimonious transformation of prices, avoiding a "kitchen-sink" approach that incorporates explicit positioning, leverage, or PB data. This keeps the framework robust to overfitting and makes it applicable across assets, regions, and historical periods where such data are often unavailable or unreliable.

Despite the appeal of such an approach, we find the BRI most effective when used in conjunction with complementary tools that can help assess whether frothy price action is supported by fundamentals – for example, more traditional valuation (e.g., PV of cash flows, valuation multiples, etc.) and/or positioning metrics (e.g., leverage, inflows, retail trading volumes etc.) where available.

10. What universe of assets will be covered in the BofA BRI Landscape?

We plan to include BRI levels on a broad set of assets covering global equity indices, large cap US equity sector indices (including the "Magnificent 7"), major commodities (including the BCOM Index), and major (Bitcoin and Ethereum). In addition to this core cross-asset universe, we plan to apply the BRI framework to popular equity themes that have experienced significant inflows over the prior week. This thematic lens is designed to spot emerging pockets of froth that may not yet be visible at the broader index or sector level.

Summary of Open Trades (26-Oct-26)

Price data for open level reflects the price on open date and does not necessarily reflect the price at which the trade could be executed at the date of this report. Our trades are structured to be executed on the open date and are not necessarily appropriate to execute as formulated beyond that date.

Table 1: Summary of open trades as of 26-Oct-26
Summary of open trades as of 26-Oct-26

Trade Description	Open Date	Open Level	Expected Trade Term	Rationale
Buy an SX5E Dec26 5000 call (for 9% indic., spot ref 4895, 45delta, 62bps vega), initially delta-hedged	5-Mar-24	9%	Dec-26	Don't miss a generational opportunity to lock in record low long-dated EU vol
Buy an SX5E Dec26 5000 call (for 9% indic., spot ref 4895, 45delta, 62bps vega), initially delta-hedged	05-Mar-24	9%	Dec-26	Attractive opportunity to lock in record low long-dated EU vol
Replicate a NKY Dec25-Dec26 36.5K FVA straddle with a static strip of options at an implied FVA level of 18.6. To trade US$100k vega	9-Sep-24	18.6v	Dec26	Long discounted Nikkei vol: Fixed strike Dec-25/Dec-26 FVA straddles at 18.6%
Trade (SPX upvar): Buy SPX Dec26 80% upvar for 18.45v indicatively (t & t-1 convention; var ref. 24.55v; fwd ref. 5551).	28-Apr-25	18.45v	Dec26	Position for spot up, vol up which leverage elevated tail skew and inverted term structure
Trade (SPX fwd upvar): Buy SPX Dec25/Dec26 80% fwd upvar for 17v indicatively (t & t-1 convention; fwd var ref. 23.6v; fwd ref. 5551).	28-Apr-25	17v	Dec26	Position for spot up, vol up which leverage elevated tail skew and inverted term structure
Long SPX 2028 annual dividend futures/short SPX 2026 annual dividend futures for $1.15 net indicatively	6-May-25	$1.15	Dec26	Position for the normalization of the dividend futures curve as time moves towards maturity and dividend growth is priced back in
Long SX5E Dec26 dividends, vs short SPX Dec26 dividends.	6-May-25	$0.00	Dec26	Dec26 dividends are more heavily discounted for SX5E than for SPX, despite what we view as higher earnings risk in SPX companies, relative to SX5E
Buy SPX Dec26 110% upvar for 11.25v indic. (t & t-1 convention; var ref. 23v; fwd ref. 5915)	2-Jun-25	11.25v	Dec26	Hedge upside pain with long delta, long vol positions that leverage elevated long-dated tail skew
Buy SPX Dec25Dec26 110% fwd upvar for 11.36v indic. (t & t-1 convention; fwd var ref. 23.3v; fwd ref. 5915).	2-Jun-25	11.36v	Dec26	Hedge upside pain with long delta, long vol positions that leverage elevated long-dated tail skew
Buy SPX Dec26 ATM upvar for 12.2v indicatively (t & t-1 convention; var ref. 22.5v)	11-Aug-25	12.2v	Dec26	Leverage record steep tail skew to enter into long vol positions via upvar
Sell SPX Dec26 var, buy SPX Dec26 60% upvar, to collect 3.5v indicatively (t & t-1 convention; var ref. 22.5v)	11-Aug-25	3.5v	Dec26	Leverage record steep tail to enter into carry trade via upvar vs var
Sell SX5E Dec26 var, buy SX5E Dec26 60% upvar, to collect 3.1v indicatively (t & t-1 convention; var ref. 21v).	18-Aug-25	3.1v	Dec 26	Vol-focused? Collect >3v on SX5E Upvar vs Var
Buy 1-year 105% 130% call spreads on a CSI 1000 tracking basket* for 3.52% (18d, 29v both legs). Consider fully financing the trade by selling 1-year 73.5% puts (37d, 29v calls vs 29.5v put)	13-Sep-25	3.52%	Oct-26	The low-cost/low risk way to buy China – deeply discounted call spreads
Buy SPX Dec26 ATM upvar for 13.95v indicatively (10v disc to vanilla; t & t-1 convention; Dec26 var ref. 24v).	3-Nov-25	13.95v	Dec26	Own spot-up, vol-up exposure as AI bubble continues to inflate.
Buy Dec26 80% put on basket of HYG (38%), SPX (29%), XLF (29%) & EEM (4%) for 1.46% (27% cheaper vs avg of individual legs)	26-Nov-25	1.46%	18-Dec-26	The convergence of private and public market risk creates opportunities for hedging private risk with liquid, public market hedges. Crucially, stress in public assets closely linked to private markets may ultimately impact private valuations, while potential hedge gains will give investors the flexibility to add risk at better terms.
Buy a basket of Dec26 90-70 put spreads on individual underlyings: SPX (53%), XLF (32%), TLT (9%) & EEM (6%) for 2.66% (weighted max payout ratio of put spreads is 7.7x)	26-Nov-25	2.66%	18-Dec-26	Given the higher volatility of the PE hedge constituents and significant decorrelation potential, we prefer buying put spreads on individual constituents rather than on the basket
Buy NDX Dec26 ATM upvar, currently 19.1v but target an entry level closer to 17v (t & t-1 convention, var ref. 29.9v)	26-Nov-25	19.1v / target 17v	18-Dec-26	Trade long-delta, long vol via upvar to capture the spot-up, vol-up typically seen in asset bubbles, with a deep discount to vanilla var
Buy long-dated OTM puts on NVDA, delta-hedged (e.g., NVDA 2y 10-delta puts)	26-Nov-25	$8.30 / 49v	21-Jan-28	Tail hedge the AI trade with long-dated NVDA vol, which historically would have shown >35x payout vs carry cost.
Sell SX5E Jun26 var (22.8v) & buy 1.7x Jun27 var (23.7v)	26-Nov-25	22.8v/23.7v	19-Jun-26	Long fwd var is most attractive for SX5E vs global peers. Resize legs to cut carry cost by 4v (45% better vs regular sizing) while preserving risk/reward
Buy 110% Dec26 SPX calls qEUR for 4.33% (17 bps over vanilla)	26-Nov-25	4.33%	18-Dec-26	Foreign investors with unhedged FX risk in their equity investments can be subject to large swings on USD volatility, which quanto options can protect against.
Buy 90% Dec26 SPX puts qAUD for 3.66% (16bps less than vanilla)	26-Nov-25	3.66%	18-Dec-26	Foreign investors with unhedged FX risk in their equity investments can be subject to large swings on USD volatility, which quanto options can protect against.
Buy Dec26 ATMf call on return dispersion on bank names for 3.50% and strike of 17.28% (SX7E spot ref: 234.93).	26-Nov-25	3.50%	18-Dec-26	EU banks' broad thematic tilt supports ongoing return dispersion. Trade gains 50% of time (including recently) and offers a 2.3x reward/risk.
Buy an 18-Sep-26 105% worst-of call on KOSPI2 / TSM US / GLD US for 3.28% (indic. qUSD, 50% disc to cheapest call, on GLD)	17-Feb-26	3.28%	18-Sep-26	Gain cheap exposure to upside in KOSPI, TSM, GLD if bubble like price action continues
Long SPX 2028 annual dividend futures outright for $80.80 indicatively.	2-Mar-26	$80.80	Dec28	Flat SPX div term structure cheapens long dated futures that could converge to bottom up div estimates as uncertainty risks decay
Long Dec27 NDX vs SPX variance swap switch for 5.25v indicatively	20-Apr-26	5.25v	Dec27	Position for asymmetric AI & tech IPO exposure as potential AI bubble inflates
Buy QQQ Dec26 90% max lookback put (daily obs.), sell QQQ Dec26 80% vanilla put, for 3.57% indic. (+1x, -1x, ref. 713.29)	11-May-26	3.57%	Dec26	Mitigate strike & timing risk in strong momentum environment with expanding put spreads
Long NDX Dec27 corridor Var replication (100%-160%) at ~20v	08-Jun-26	20v	Dec27	Strong pipeline of AI/tech IPOs that could qualify for NDX fast-entry in full view, our conviction in owning NDX vol remains strong
Buy NDX Dec27 90% upvar, sell SPX Dec27 80% upvar for 4.9v (t & t-1 convention on both legs).	08-Jun-26	4.9v	Dec27	Cheapen NDX vs SPX var switch for further AI bubble expansion
NDX Dec26 110% call contingent on EURUSD < 100.75% for 1.55% (60% discount to vanilla)	22-Jun-26	1.55%	Dec26	Cheapen tech upside with equity-FX correlation amidst hawkish Fed shift
Buy SPX Dec26 95%-80% put down-and-out (daily obs.) for 0.55% indic. (62% discount to vanilla put spread; ref. 7615)	03-Aug-26	0.55%	Dec26	Hedge equity downside with grind lower structure in rotation-prone market
Dec27 197/205 1x2 call ratios on DEDZ8 (ref: 195).	25-Aug-26	0	Dec27	Lever limited SX5E div upside via call ratios, amid index change uncertainty
DEDZ8 Dec-28 197/205 1x2 call ratio financed by DEDZ7 Dec-27 192 call for (refs: 195.2, 188.4 respectively)	25-Aug-26	0	Dec28	Lever limited SX5E div upside via call ratios, amid index change uncertainty

Table 1: Summary of open trades as of 26-Oct-26
Summary of open trades as of 26-Oct-26

Trade Description	Open Date	Open Level	Expected Trade Term	Rationale
Buy SPX Dec26 95% / 80% put down & out (daily obs.) for 0.55% indic. (50% discount vs vanilla put spread; ~25d/5d strikes; ref. 76.33.48)	01-Sep-26	0.55%	Dec26	Grind lower hedge against adverse midterm election outcome
Sell VIX Oct 16 put, buy VIX Nov 22-30 call spread for $0.50 indic. (UXV6 ref. 18.85, UXX6 ref. 19.30)	01-Sep-26	$0.39	Nov26	Monetize vol support from midterm election risk to cheapen long vol hedge
Buy IWM Nov 280 put for $6.13 (~96%/33d strike; 20.3v; ref. 290.44)	01-Sep-26	$6.13 / 2.1%	Nov26	Small cap vol looks underpriced for midterm elections vs 2024 presidential election move
Hedge near-term French political risk via long Dec26 qEUR SX7E < 94% & EURCHF < 0.92 dual digital for 10% offer (10x max payout, implied correl: ~30%).	08-Sep-26	10%	Dec26	Hedge near-term French political risk
SXEP short calendar put ratio: Sell 1x SXEP Oct26 530 (~25D) put, buy 1.5x SXEP Dec26 500 (~18D) puts, for 81bp offer (Sep future ref: 552).	14-Sep-26	81bp	Dec26	Hedge eventual war de-escalation via calendar put ratios
Buy QQQ Oct26 730 calls for $6.89 indicatively (~0.97% of spot; 16v, ~31d / 103% strike; ref. 709.18).	14-Sep-26	$6.89	Oct26	Leverage retreating call vols to buy the dip in tech with limited risk
SX7E Dec26 30D put, initially delta-hedged for 2.5% (94%f, 26% implied vol).	28-Sep-26	2.5%	Dec26	Hedge Eurozone banks, as higher rates also pose higher risks
Dec26 put spreads, e.g. 30D-20D put spreads for 1.2%, offering >4x max payout ratio. (refs, SX7E: 316.20, EUSA10: 3.723%)	28-Sep-26	1.2%	Dec26	Hedge Eurozone banks, as higher rates also pose higher risks
SX7E < 92%, EUSA10 < 3.45% Dec26 dual-digital for 5.8% (17:1 maximum payout ratio, ~25D strikes for both assets). (refs, SX7E: 316.20, EUSA10: 3.723%)	28-Sep-26	5.8%	Dec26	Hedge Eurozone banks, as higher rates also pose higher risks
SX7E Dec26 92% put contingent on EUSA10 < 3.45% for 44bps. (refs, SX7E: 316.20, EUSA10: 3.723%)	28-Sep-26	44bps	Dec26	Hedge Eurozone banks, as higher rates also pose higher risks
Buy QQQ Nov26 775-825 call spread for $11.63 indicatively (4.3x max payout ratio; ~40d/10d strikes; ref. 756.20)	05-Oct-26	$11.63	Nov26	Hedge US tech continuing to overcome macro with limited risk
Buy a Jun27 15% call on return dispersion on liquid* European banks for 2.8% (forward: 13.8%, implied correlation: 55%) (*Stocks: BNP FP, ACA FP, GLE FP, CBK GY, UCG IM, INGA NA, SAN SQ and ABN NA)	12-Oct-26	2.8%	Jun27	French fiscal, political and sovereign risks converge: a case for Banks dispersion
Buy NDX Sep27 90% max lookback put (daily obs.) contingent on 10y SOFR < ATMf-25bps for 3.62% indicatively (46% discount to max lookback put, 23bps lower premium than vanilla put; ref. 30904, 4.919%)	12-Oct-26	3.62%	Sep27	If AI slowdown plays out as equity lower, rates lower, minimize timing risk at a low cost with max lookback put contingent on lower rates
Buy VIX Nov 19-24 call spread for $0.63 indicatively on mids (7.9x max payout ratio; ~45d/25d strikes; UXX6 ref. 17.61).	12-Oct-26	$0.63	Nov26	Hedge near-term vol risk with tight VIX call spreads due to positioning backdrop
Long 1x SX7E Jun27 260 put (~30d, ref: 283.7) for 5.7%, more than fully funded from the carry and roll (+81bp) from short 8.8x Snr Fin (S46) CDS protection @ 72bp. (Eg: 100mn CDS <-> 11.4mn SX7E).	19-Oct-26	0	Jun27	EZ Banks credit-equity RV attractive
Buy XLP Nov 85 puts, sell equal notional of XLK Nov 175 puts for 0.23% credit indicatively (~25d strikes; 2.1:1 contracts; ref. 87.21, 185.96)	19-Oct-26	0.23% credit	Nov26	Hedge high BRI defensives with XLP/XLV vs XLV put vs put
Buy XLV Nov 170 puts, sell equal notional of XLK Nov 175 puts for 0.20% credit indicatively (~25d strikes; 1.05:1 contracts; ref. 175.65, 185.96)	19-Oct-26	0.20% credit	Nov26	Hedge high BRI defensives with XLP/XLV vs XLV put vs put

Source: BofA Global Research. Prices reflective of most recently available data which may be delayed in some cases. "Trade Value" represents current valuation of trades initiated on the "Open Date"

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Summary of Closed Trades (26-Oct-26)

Table 2: Summary of closed trades as of 26-Oct-26
Summary of closed trades as of 26-Oct-26

Trade Description	Open Date	Open Level	Close Level	Close Date	Rationale
Long SX5E 12-Sep ATM straddle for 2.4% indic. (Ref: 5291) and look to enter long V2X Oct, short Nov futures at -0.6v or better.	2-Sep-25	2.5%/-0.6v	0/-2.05v	Nov-25	Trade expired
Trade 1 (protection): Zero cost XIN9I 3-month 96% 90% 1x3 put ratios for 0.05% credit, rolled 1-2 months into the trade (indic. spot ref 14,962, delta -6.1%, vols: 18.5/17.4)): +3x 90% puts -1x 96% put	26-Aug-25	0%	0	Nov 25	Trade expired
Trade 2 (participation): XIN9I call spreads for investors wanting to add upside. Buy XIN9I 3m 105% 115% call spread for 1.38% (indic. spot ref: 14,962, 20% delta, vols: 20.1/23.0, 7.2x max payout)	26-Aug-25	1.38%	0	Nov 25	Trade expired
XIN9I 3-month 95% 85% put spreads for 1.7% (indic. spot ref 14,825, delta -22%, vols: 20/21v, 5.9x max payout)	9-Sep-25	1.7%	0	Nov 25	Trade expired
Buy long VIX Nov 18 puts vs short VIX Apr 18 puts for $0.10 indicatively	22-Sep-25	$0.10	$23.9	Nov-25	Trade expired
Buy NDX Dec25 ATM upvar for 17v indicatively (t & t-1 convention, Dec25 var ref. 25.1v)	26-Nov-24	17v	15.77v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy NDX Dec25 80% upvar for 20.15v indicatively (t & t-1 convention, Dec25 var ref. 25.1v)	26-Nov-24	20.15v	23.36v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired ITM
Buy NDX Dec25 ATM upvar for 16.8v indicatively (t & t-1 convention)	27-Jan-25	16.8v	15.12v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy NDX Dec25 ATM upvar for 18.15v indicatively (t & t-1 convention)	24-Mar-25	18.15v	14.98v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy 31-Dec-25 SPX 6250/5750/5250 put ladder (+1x / -1x / -1x) for $40.1 indicatively (12.4x max payout ratio; spot ref. 6373.45)	11-Aug-25	$40.10	0	31-Dec-25	Trade expired
Long SPX Dec 6300/5800 put spreads for ~$75 indicatively or 1.16% of spot (6.6x max payout ratio; ref. 6449.23), outright or paired with long VIX Nov 18/15 put spreads for $1.13 indicatively (2.6x max payout ratio, UXX5 ref. 20.70)	18-Aug-25	$75 / $1.13	0 / 1.99	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy SPX 31-Dec-25 95% / 85% down-and-out put for 0.31% indic (cont. obs., 32x max payout ratio, 68% discount to vanilla put spread; ref. 6654).	13-Sep-25	31bps	0	31-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy SPX 31-Dec-25 95% / 85% down-and-out put for 0.28% indic (cont. obs., 35x max payout ratio, 65% discount to vanilla put spread; ref. 6735.13).	20-Oct-25	28bps	0	31-Dec-25	Trade expired
Sell VIX Dec 16.5 puts (UXZ5 ref. 19.93) to buy SPX Dec 7000/7250 call spreads (spot ref. 6852.43). Sizing for zero cost is ~0.7 SPX call spreads per ~100 VIX puts sold.	3-Nov-25	$0.00	-$0.49	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy 19-Dec-25 85%/65% Best of Put spreads on NKY/KOSPI2/ SPX for 0.90% (indic. quanto USD, 56% discount to avg vanilla)	26-Nov-24	0.90%	0	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy VIX Feb26 15.5/20/25 call spread collar for $0.11 indicatively (UXG6 ref. 17.92)	12-Jan-26	$0.11	0	18-Feb-26	Trade expired
Buy NKY Dec25/Dec26 31,000 straddle FVAs for 21.27% (indic. Q=2.5%, R=0.5%)	7-Apr-25	21.27%	9.39%	Dec25	Trade expired ITM
Dec25 +DAX vs -SXDP zero-premium call switch (20-delta strikes, refs: 24160 and 1036 respectively)	15-Jul-25	0%	-2%	Dec-25	Trade expired
Long SX7E Dec25 Appearing Put Spread (€205-€185-€160) for 2.65% (ref: 216.89)	4-Aug-25	2.65%	0	Dec25	Trade expired
Long Dec25 DAX vs SX5E 102.5% outperformance, conditioned on EURUSD > 1.2 at expiry for 0.84%	11-Aug-25	0.84%	0	Dec25	Trade expired
Buy DAX Dec25 call spread collar (+24800 call-25500 call-22400 put) for 0 cost	18-Aug 25	0	0	Dec 25	Trade expired
Buy DAX Dec25 105% call contingent on EURUSD > 1.20 for 0.77%	18-Aug 25	0.77%	0	Dec 25	Trade expired
Buy SX5E Dec25 put ladder +5350/-5125/-4875 for 10bps premium indicatively	18-Aug 25	10bps	0	Dec 25	Trade expired
Replace FTSE longs with Dec25 103% (~28D) calls for 80bps (ref: 9299.84)	29-Sep-25	80bps	3.21%	Dec-25	Trade expired
Long Dec25 35d-15d (97.2%-92.3%) CAC put spreads for 0.98% indic (max payout ratio of 5.7x)	27-Oct-25	0.98%	0	Dec 25	Trade expired
DAX Dec25 102.5% calls, contingent on the CAC <102.5% at expiry for 39bps (~69% discount vs vanilla calls)	27-Oct-25	39bps	0	Dec 25	Trade expired
Long Dec25 VolSwap dispersion on custom names vs the ESTX50	26-Nov-24	9.5v	12.0v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired +2.5%
Buy DAX Dec-25 85% upvar for 18.3v (fair variance ref of 23.3v)	11-Mar-25	18.3v	17v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Long SX5E Dec25 Volswap, short SX5E Dec25 Varswap for a credit of 2.9v indicatively (var ref: 23.75). For a more defensive alternative, short 0.95x Varswap vs the Volswap for 1.7v, indicatively.	6-May-25	2.9 credit	-4.3v	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Long SX7E-SX5E Mar26 60-110% Corridor Var Spread for 7.7v (vanilla var refs. 9.9v, 31.5v & 21.6 respectively, T&T-1 convention)	4-Aug-25	7.7v	10.2v	20-Mar-26	Trade expired ITM
S&P calls quantoed into EUR (for only 3 bps more than vanilla Dec25 102.5% calls that cost 1.86%).	22-Sep-25	1.89%	0%	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Cheapening S&P calls by conditioning on EUR higher, also quantoed into EUR for 1.23%, a 35% cheapening vs Dec25 SPX 102.5% calls qEUR).	22-Sep-25	1.23%	0%	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Sell SX5E Dec25 ATM Downvar vs buy Var to collect 4.7v (T-convention, var ref: 19v)	29-Sep-25	4.7v	4.7v collected	19-Dec-25	Trade expired ITM
Buy Dec25 FTSE div futures as a Dollar (vs Sterling) strength beneficiary	26-Nov-24	299.5	3.9 GBP	19-Dec-25	Trade expired
Long HSCEI 21-Nov-25 1x1.5 105% 110% call ratios for 0.39% (indic., options on futs, spot ref: 8,893,12.8x may payout)	4-Aug-25	0.39%	0	21-Nov 25	Trade expired
Buy 12-Dec 25 NKY>SPX 103% outperf calls for 2.60% (indic.)	18-Aug-25	2.60%	1.27%	Dec 25	Trade expired ITM
Buy KOSPI2 3-month 105-115% call spreads for 1.62% (indic. spot ref: 478, 24d, vols: 19.2%/19.4%)	22-Sep-25	1.62%	8.38%	Dec-25	Trade expired ITM
Buy NKY 3-month 105% 115% call spreads for 1.62% (indic. Spot ref: 45,043, 24.6 delta, vols: 19.2/18.8, 6.2x max payout)	29-Sep-25	1.62%	3.29%	Dec-25	Trade expired ITM
Buy a TWSE 1m/2m 30k call calendar for TWD 183 (0.65% of spot, indic. spot ref: 27,994, 9d, +17.3 vega, vols: 18.3%/18.2%)	27-Oct-25	TWD 183	0	Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy NIFTYM 24-Feb-26 25.5k/26.5k call spread for USD 189 (indic. 0.75% of spot, spot ref: 25,048, vols: 11.9%/11.4%, delta 29.3%).	26-Jan-26	$189	0	24-Feb-26	Trade expired
Buy TWSE 18-Mar 34.5k calls funded by selling 23-Feb 30.5k 28.9k put spreads for TW$65 (spot ref: 32,065)	26-Jan-26	TW$65	0	18-Mar-26	Trade expired
Sell NKY 13-Feb 57k calls to fund 13-Mar 57k/60k call spreads for JPY 277: 10.8x max payout (indic. 0.52% of spot, ref: 53,806, 31.9v 28.6v 28.3v, delta -2%)	2-Feb-26	JPY 277	0	13-Mar-26	Trade expired
Buy QQQ Mar26 660-720 call spread for $8.92 indicatively (6.7x max payout ratio; ~27d/7d strikes; ref. 599.44).	29-Sep-25	$8.92	0	Mar26	Trade expired
Buy SPX Mar26 105% call contingent on XAU > 102% at expiry for 1.31% indicatively	29-Sep-25	1.31%	0	Mar26	Trade expired
Buy QQQ Mar26 675-735 call spread for $8.25 (7.3x max payout ratio; ~25d/7d strikes; ref. 611.56).	20-Oct-25	$8.25	0	Mar26	Trade expired
Buy TLT Mar26 88 puts for $1.31 (~30D strike, 4.1% OTM, ref. 91.78)	27-Oct-25	$1.31	$2.17	Mar26	Trade expired ITM
Buy TLT (20+Yr Treasury Bond ETF) Mar26 86 puts for $1.03 (~25D strike, ref. 90.01)	26-Nov-25	$1.03	$0.17	Mar26	Trade expired ITM
Buy 30y SOFR > ATMf + 20bps / XAU > 106% Mar26 dual digitals for 7.95% (12.5x max payout ratio, -18 correl offer, ref. 3.955%, 4078.70)	26-Nov-25	7.95%	0	Mar26	Trade expired
Buy GLD Mar26 490-550 call spread for $9.9 indicatively (6x max payout; ~36d (5% OTM) / 11d (18% OTM) strikes; ref. 464.7)	26-Jan-26	$9.9	0	Mar26	Trade expired

Table 2: Summary of closed trades as of 26-Oct-26
Summary of closed trades as of 26-Oct-26

Trade Description	Open Date	Open Level	Close Level	Close Date	Rationale
Buy 1x EWZ Mar26 40 call, sell 1x Jul26 48 call for 14c indicatively (28d/14d strikes, ref. 37.585)	17-Feb-26	$0.14	-0.18	Mar26	Trade expired
Buy Mar26 straddle on liquid EZ banks vs short SX7E straddle for 2.36%	26-Nov-25	2.36%	1.2%	20-Mar-26	Trade expired ITM
Buy SPX MarQ 6525-5925 put spread for $50 indicatively, ref 6795.99.	9-Mar-26	$50.00	$0	31-Mar-26	Trade expired
Buy IWM MarQ 240-215 put spread for $2.60 indicatively, ref 253.62.	9-Mar-26	$2.60	$0	31-Mar-26	Trade expired
Buy GLD Apr26 450 calls (~106% / 35d strike), sell SLV Apr26 120 calls (~155% / 17d strike) notional-matched for zero cost indicatively (ref. 423.26, 77.34).	12-Jan-26	$0	$0	17-Apr-26	Trade expired
Buy SPX Apr26 6800/6300/5800 put ladder (+1x/-1x/-1x) for $63.8 indicatively (7.8x max payout; ~40d/15d/5d strikes; ref. 6881.62).	2-Mar-26	$63.8	$0	17-Apr-26	Trade expired
Buy SPX Apr26 97%/85% PDO for 57bps indicatively (50% discount to vanilla put spread; ref. 6881.62).	2-Mar-26	57bps	0%	17-Apr-26	Trade expired
Buy VIX Apr 20-18 put spread for $0.50 mid indicatively (4x max payout ratio; UXJ6 ref. 24.30)	23-Mar-26	$0.5 mid	$2	15-Apr-26	Trade expired ITM
Long SX5E Apr26 6175 (~30d) call (1.2%, ref 5992.4), short V2X Apr26 18 put (ref 20.6) in a ~1:8 contract ratio for almost 0 cost (10bps credit of eq. notional)	17-Feb-26	10bps	0	Apr-26	Trade expired
Buy SXEP<95%, USO US > 110% May26 dual digital for qUSD 8.9% indicatively (11.2x max payout; ref. 517.66, 117.06)	16-Mar-26	8.9%	0	May26	Trade expired
Buy USO May26 80/70/60 put fly (+1x/-2x/1x) for $1.9 mid indicatively (5.2x max payout ratio; ~30d/15d/5d strikes; ref. 87.19).	2-Mar-26	$1.9 mid	0	May26	Trade expired
Buy VIX May26 18/25/40 call spread collar for $1.03 indicatively on mids + bid-offer TBD at time of trade (14.5x max payout ratio; UXK6 ref. 22.95).	16-Mar-26	$1.03 mid	0	May26	Trade expired
Buy VIX May 25-35 call spread for $0.82 indicatively (12.2x max payout; UXK6 ref. 21.05).	13-Apr-26	$0.82	0	May26	Trade expired
Buy VIX May 24-40 call spread for $0.93 indicatively (~35d/10d strikes, 17.2x max payout, UXK6 ref. 20.81)	20-Apr-26	$0.93	0	May26	Trade expired
Buy QQQ 29-May-26 635 call for $9 indicatively (1.46% of spot; ~103% / 35d strike; 16.8v; ref. 617.507).	13-Apr-26	$9	$103.31	29-May-26	Trade expired ITM
Buy QQQ 29-May-26 665-700 call spread for $7.5 indicatively (~35d/10d strikes, 4.7x payout, ref. 646.85)	20-Apr-26	$7.5	$35	29-May-26	Trade expired ITM
Sell initially delta-hedged KOSPI2 30-Dec-25 110% calls and collect 1.12% (indic. spot ref 535.28, 23.7% vol, 20d). Consider hedging the risk of a global tech rally into year-end by buying QQQ 31-Dec-25 110% calls against the KOSPI2 calls for 0.56% (17.8% vols, 14d)	20-Oct-25	1.12/0.56%	0	30-Dec-25	Trade expired
Buy 1x 20-Mar-2026 106% call on a CSI 1000 tracking basket* for 2.92% (+29d, 27.4v). Sell 1x ASHR US 20-Mar-2026 35 call for $0.71 (~2.15% of spot; the 35.00 strike is 106% of spot, ref 33.00) (*= several banks offer CSI tracking baskets; indic. in quanto USD)	3-Nov-25	2.92/2.15%	0	20-Mar-26	Trade expired
Buy 1x 20-Mar-2026 106% call on a CSI 1000 tracking basket* for 2.32% (+27d, 26v). Sell 1.05x ASHR US 20-Mar-2026 34 calls for $0.55 (~1.73% of spot; the 34.00 strike is ~107% of spot, ref 31.76)	26-Nov-25	2.32%/~1.73%	0.88%	20-Mar-26	Trade expired ITM
Buy KOSPI2 3-month put vs. short call spread for a 0.39% of spot, +1x 88% put / -1x 110% call / +1x 120% call	12-Jan-26	0.39%	0	Apr26	Trade expired
Buy HSCEI 17-Apr-26 9,500 10,500 call spreads financed by selling 8,500 puts for $73 (indic. OOF, Apr fut ref 9,222, 47d)	9-Feb-26	$73	0	Apr26	Trade expired
Buy 6-month 105% 125% call spreads on a CSI 1000 tracking basket for 2.53% (indic. 20d, 27.1v/28.7v, quanto USD)	26-Nov-25	2.53%	12.25%	15-May-26	Trade expired ITM
Buy Jun26 NKY > 104% & USDJPY < 96% dual digital for 9.7% (+48 correl offer, 10.3x max payout, ref. 48626, 157).	26-Nov-25	9.7%	0	12-Jun-26	Trade expired
Buy SPX Jun 6900 / 7600 risk reversal (-1x / +1x), delta-hedged (~95% / 105% strikes; 19.15v/11.96v; spot ref. 7268.50).	5-May-26	~19.2v/12v	~$10.90	Jun26	Trade expired
Buy VIX Jun 25-40 call spread for $1 indic (15x max payout; UXM6 ref. 20.95)	11-May-26	$1	$0	Jun26	Trade expired
Buy TLT Jun 82-78 put spread for 51c indicatively (7.8x max payout ratio; 30d-8d strikes; ref. 83.65)	18-May-26	$0.51	$0	Jun26	Trade expired
Buy SPX Jun26 95% put contingent on Brent > 130 for 84bps indicatively (68% discount to vanilla; ref. 6643.11, 101.84)	16-Mar-26	84bps	$0	Jun26	Trade expired
Buy QQQ Jun26 660-750 call spread for $18 (~35D/10D strikes, 5x max payout ratio, ref. 605.16)	26-Nov-25	$18.00	$80.66	18-Jun-26	Trade expired ITM
Buy Jun26 105% DAX call contingent on CAC < 105% at expiry	26-Nov-25	1.24%	0.2%	19-Jun-26	Trade expired ITM
Long CAC Mar26-Jun26 zero-cost put calendars, e.g. a Jun26 30D put fully funds ~1.6x Mar26 30D puts (spot ref: 8336.72)	12-Jan-26	0	5%	Jun26	Trade expired ITM
Long Jun26 105% DAX call, contingent on CAC < 105% at expiry for 1.12% (>50% discount vs vanilla calls)	12-Jan-26	1.12%	0	Jun26	Trade expired
Sell NKY 9-Jan-26 55,000 calls for a JPY589 credit (~1.12% of spot, or 6.7% annualised, 23d 23.1 vol)	10-Nov-25	JPY589	1.12%	09-Jan-26	Trade expired ITM
Buy Jun26 110% Worst-of Call on SXPP, SXEP, SX7E for 76bps offer (~50% discount vs the cheapest vanilla, spot refs: SXPP 737.05, SXEP 435.90, SX7E 275.44).	2-Feb-26	76bps	0	Jun26	Trade expired
SXEP Jun26 500 (~30D) puts initially delta-hedged	20-Apr-26	2.3% (put)	0	Jun26	Trade expired
Buy Jun26 1x2 +19-17 V2X put ratios for 0.475 (fut ref: 21.95)	11-May-26	0.475	1.26	Jun26	Trade expired
Sell SOXX Jun26 485-540 1x2 call ratios (-1x / +2x), delta-hedged (~40d/20d strikes; ~41v/43v; ref. 455.410)	27-Apr-26	41v/43v	$36.62	Jun26	Trade expired ITM
Buy 1.00x 18-Jun-2026 106% call on a CSI 1000 tracking basket* for 3.58% (+31d, 29v). Sell 1.05x ASHR US 18-Jun-2026 36 calls for $0.74 (~2.20% of spot; the 36.00 strike is ~106% of spot, ref 33.82)	17-Feb-26	1.38%	-0.9%	18-Jun-26	Trade expired
Sell SOXX Jul 550/500 1x2 put ratio (-1x / +2x) for ~$0 indicatively (40d / 20d strikes; ref. 570.34).	26-May-26	$0	-$28.19	Jul26	Trade expired
Buy QQQ Jul 750-800 call spread for $7.62 (6.5x max payout ratio; 28d-5d strikes; ref. 716.07)	08-Jun-26	$7.62	$0	Jul26	Trade expired
SX7E Jul26 102% calls contingent on SX7P remaining at or below 102% for 0.77% qEUR (78% discount vs SX7E vanilla calls; 90% implied correl).	18-May-26	0.77%	0	Jul26	Trade expired
SX5E > 105%, EURGBP > 0.88 Jul26 dual digital for 7.69% (implied correlation offer -22%, refs: 5800 & 0.87 respectively, 13x max payout)	18-May-26	7.69%	0	Jul26	Trade expired
Buy SXPP 2m (~Jul26) 1x2 40d-24d (105%-112%) call ratios for zero premium (spot ref: 841.03%) with a max payout of ~7%, to position for moderate further upside potential.	26-May-26	0	0	Jul26	Trade expired
Buy SPX 2-July 7435 daily straddle for 1.14% (spot ref: 7433) and this can be cheapened to 12bps by selling a SX5E 2-July (End-of-day) 4925 for 1.02% (spot ref: 6231)	29-Jun-26	12bps	0	02-Jul-26	Trade expired
Buy NKY 6-month 95% put with vol knock out at 28% for 1.59% (indic., spot ref: 52,991, -11d, 69% discount to vanilla)	20-Jan-26	1.59%	0	Jul26	Trade expired
Buy XLV Aug26 165/170 call spread for $1.2 indic. (4.1x max payout ratio; ~35d/10d strikes; ref. 162.19)	03-Aug-26	$1.2	$5	Aug26	Trade expired ITM
SPX > 109% / USDJPY > 100% Sep '26 dual digitals for 10% indic (10x max payout; target=90c; stop=10c, ref. 7360/156.73, -6 correl)	8-May-26	10%	0	Sep26	Trade expired
NDX Sep26 107% calls contingent on GBPUSD <1.32 for 1.06% (60% discount vs vanilla, refs: 29125 and 1.335 respectively)	18-May-26	1.06%	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy NDX Sep26 105% calls contingent on ATMf < 10y SOFR < ATMf+25bps for 1.35% indicatively (57% discount to vanilla; ref. 30900, 4.09%)	15-Jun-26	1.35%	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy VIX Sep 25-40 call spread for $0.92 (16.3x max payout; ~35d/15d strikes; UXU6 ref. 19.65).	13-Jul-26	$0.92	0	Sep26	Trade expired

Table 2: Summary of closed trades as of 26-Oct-26

Summary of closed trades as of 26-Oct-26

Trade Description	Open Date	Open Level	Close Level	Close Date	Rationale
Buy SMH Sep 650-750 call spread for $14.6 indicatively (6.8x max payout ratio; ~28d/10d strikes; ref. 558.83).	20-Jul-26	$14.6	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy SPX Sep26 7900 calls for $73.30 indic (~35d strike; 12.05v; ref. 7753.11)	10-Aug-26	$73.3	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy GDX Sep26 95 / 110 call spread for $3.03 indic (~5x max payout ratio; ~40d / 15d strikes; ref. 90.49)	10-Aug-26	$3.03	$0.48	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy TLT 18-Sep-26 80.5-79 put spread and 81.5-83 call spread for $0.49 indicatively (0.6% of spot; ref. 80.93).	14-Sep-26	$0.49	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Sep-26 SX7E>106%, EURUSD < 1.14 dual-digital for 10.49% (offering 9.5:1 leverage)	22-Jun-26	10.49%	0	Sep26	Trade expired
SX7E Sep26 106% call, contingent on EURUSD <1.14 at maturity for 1.01% (58% discount vs vanilla calls)	22-Jun-26	1.01%	0	Sep26	Trade expired
SX7E Sep26 107% call, contingent on SX5E <= 104% at maturity for 1% (54% discount vs vanilla calls). Trade refs: 295, 1.1451, 6294 respectively	22-Jun-26	1%	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy Sep26 30D-15D (118%-134%) call spread on ENR fully funded by selling a Sep26 35D put on SXEP (refs: 157.06, 482.47)	29-Jun-26	0	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy 0.84x Sep26 97% SX5E put, funded by a short 97.6% Sep26 SXXP put (~31% delta each, refs: 6265.98, 640.52 respectively)	13-Jul-26	0	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy 1.1x SX5E Sep26 30-delta puts, fully funded by 1x SX6P Sep26 30-delta put. Alternatively, 1:1 for a small credit ~13bps (spot refs: SX5E: 6539.59, SX6P: 540.77).	18-Aug-26	0	~2.8%	Sep26	Trade expired ITM
Buy US 6m5y receivers ATM-25bps contingent on SPX < 100% for 34c indicatively (ref. 3.63%, 6650)	2-Apr-26	34c	0	2-Oct-26	Trade expired
Buy 5y SOFR < ATM-25bp & SPX < 92.5% 6m dual digitals for 10% indicatively (ref. 3.63%, 6650)	2-Apr-26	10%	0	2-Oct-26	Trade expired
Buy Sep26 NKY>104% & USDJPY<98% dual digital for 16% (+32 correl offer, ref: 56,942, 153.6) 6.25x max payout	17-Feb-26	16%	0	Sep26	Trade expired
Buy NKY 3-month 95% put with an 80% Knock Out for 1.15% (indicative, -7% delta, 74% discount to vanilla put)	13-Jul-26	1.15%	0	13-Oct-26	Trade expired
Buy the 19-Aug-26 2330 TT 110% 120% 1x2 call ratio for 1.3% (7.7x max payout, +6 delta, 43.0% 39.0% vols) +1x 110% call / -2x 120% calls	13-Jul-26	1.3%	0	19-Aug-26	Trade expired

Source: BofA Global Research. Prices reflective of most recently available data which may be delayed in some cases. "Trade Value" represents current valuation of trades initiated on the "Open Date"

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

Acronyms

BTD: Buy-the-dip

DUV: deep ultraviolet

FOMC = Federal Open Market Committee

NFP = Non-Farm Payrolls

SPY = SPDR S&P 500 ETF Trust (ETF)

QQQ = Invesco QQQ Trust (ETF)

CPI = Consumer Price Index

XLF = Financial Select Sector SPDR Fund (ETF)

ATM = At-The-Money

XLV = SPDR Healthcare ETF

PDO = puts down-and-out

ENGI = Engie

WKL = Wolters Kluwer

VOW3 = Volkswagen

MLCC = Multilayer Ceramic Capacitor

MU = Micron

INTC = Intel

AFD = Alternative für Deutschland (Alternative for Germany)

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